

Site 164. Ras Quneitra

Israel Grid 1928/1673, Elevation 300 m a.s.l.; 94 flint artefacts (Fig. A21).

Artefacts without retouch: Core 2; Primary flake 9; Flake 36; Blade 6; Bladelet 1; Ridge blade 2; Levallois blade 1; Levallois point 1. Total 58.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 3; Side-scraper 4; Burin 2; Borer 1; Retouched flake 8; Retouched blade 2; Backed knife 1; Notch 4; Denticulate 3; Truncation 2; Retouched Levallois flake 2; Retouched Levallois blade 2; Varia 2. Total 36.

The artefacts were made from light brown flint with some white-grey patina.

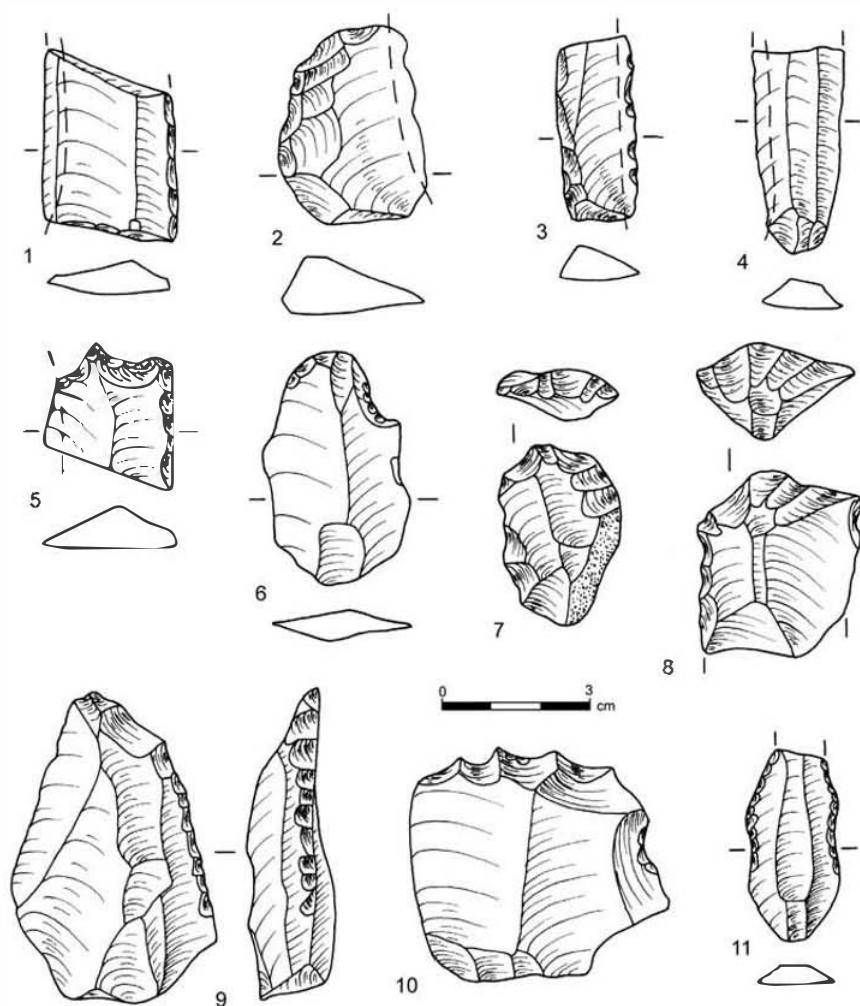


Fig. A20. Kh. Tawil (1): 1-4-Sickle blades; 5-Awl on broken sickle blade; 6-Notch; 7, 8-End-scrapers. Merah es-Sahlat: 9-Side-scraper; 10-Denticulate; 11-Retouched blade.

The composition of the assemblage points clearly to the Middle Palaeolithic. The Levallois artefacts, most of them with faceted bases, and the relative high number of side-scrapers, confirm this dating. 2.5% of the ceramics were Chalcolithic, and the rest were from late historical periods. Thus, despite the fact that no diagnostic items were found, some of the flints could originate from the Chalcolithic.

Periods: Middle Palaeolithic – highly reasonable identification.

Chalcolithic – possible identification.

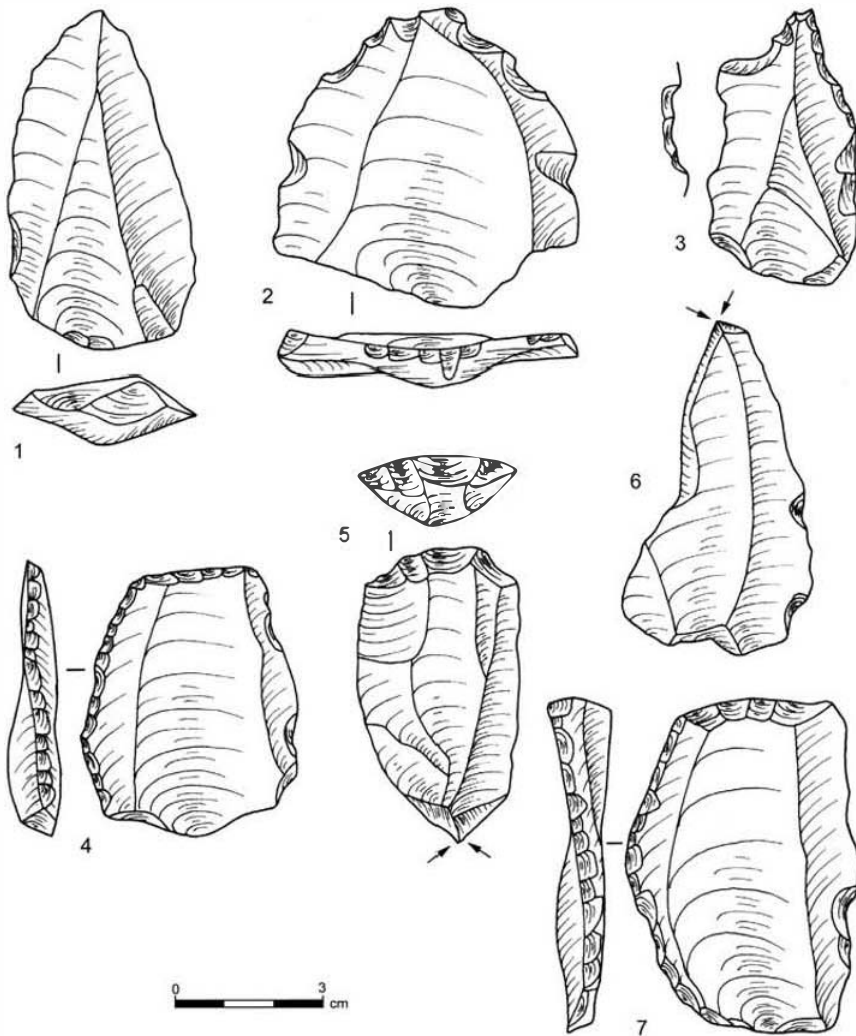


Fig. A21. Ras Quneitra: 1-Levallois point; 2-Denticulate on Levallois flake; 3-Borer; 4-Side-scraper. 'Ein el-Mana: 5-Burin-scraper; 6-Burin; 7-Side-scraper.

Site 169. 'Ein el-Mana

Israel Grid 1914/1660, Elevation 5 m a.s.l.; 98 flint artefacts (Fig. A21).

Artefacts without retouch: Discoidal Levallois core 1; Core 1; Primary flake 21; Chunk 4; Flake 31; Blade 19; Levallois flake 2; Total 79.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 2; Scraper-burin 1; Side-scraper 5; Burin 2; Retouched flake 5; Notch 3; Truncation 1. Total 19.

Most artefacts were made from violet flint with light beige patina, and some pieces were from white, calcareous flint. Some of the patinated items had secondary retouch without patina. The discoidal core, the Levallois flakes and the relatively high number of side-scrapers definitely indicate the Middle Palaeolithic. 12% of the pottery are from IA II, indicating the repeated phenomenon of repopulation of some Middle Palaeolithic sites in the IA. No diagnostic items were found, but some of the flints could originate from this period.

Periods: Middle Palaeolithic – highly reasonable identification (part of the finds).

IA II – possible identification (part of the finds).

Site 170. E.P. 278

Israel Grid 1926/1667, Elevation 278 m a.s.l.

According to the records about 100 flint artefacts attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic had been collected at the site. The artefacts had not been located when this study was prepared.

Site 172. Lower Sartaba

Israel Grid 1934/1668, Elevation 310 m a.s.l.; 15 flint artefacts.

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 1; Flake 3; Blade 6. Total 10.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 2; Retouched blade 2; Denticulate 1. Total 5.

The pottery was from the Hellenistic period and later. Most flint artefacts were made from violet flint with a thick light-coloured patina. The bases and the bulbs of percussion prove that these were man-made products. Some of the artefacts had a secondary retouch, and the scars had a second different patina. The end-scraper and the relative numerous blades may indicate the Upper Palaeolithic.

Period: Upper Palaeolithic – possible identification.

Site 173. Sartaba Fortress*Israel Grid 1937/1670, Elevation 377 m a.s.l.; 15 flint artefacts.*

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 4; Chunk 1; Flake 2; Blade 5. Total 12.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Burin 1; Retouched blade 1; Notch 1. Total 3.

Most items were from light brown flint with a faint light grey patina. Blades were relatively numerous, and all the tools were prepared on blades. These facts indicate the Upper Palaeolithic to some extent.

The proximity of Sites 172 and 173 – both possibly attributed to the Upper Palaeolithic – apparently confirms this assumption.

Period: Upper Palaeolithic – possible identification.

Site 174. E.P. 416*Israel Grid 1864/1659, Elevation 380 m a.s.l.; 11 flint artefacts.*

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 1; Chunk 1; Flake 5. Total 7.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Notch 3; Varia 1. Total 4.

15% of the pottery were from IA II, and the rest from late historical periods. Indications of periods prior to IA II were not found; thus the flint artefacts should also be attributed to this period.

Period: IA II – reasonable identification.

Site 175. 'Ein es-Sukhun*Israel Grid 1887/1651, Elevation 50 m a.s.l.; 271 flint artefacts (Fig. A22).*

Previous publication: Nadel et al. 2000.

Artefacts without retouch: Core 17; Primary flake 25; Core trimming element 1; Chunk 20; Chip 10; Flake 80; Blade 23; Bladelet 8; Hammerstone 2. Total 186.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 2; Side-scraper 3; Burin 10; Awl 2; Borer 1; Retouched flake 8; Retouched blade 11; Backed knife 2; Sickle blade 1; Notch 11; Denticulate 2; Truncation 2; Axe 2; Arrow head 1; Nakhal Khemar knife (fragment) 2; Retouched and charred items 25; Varia 5. Total 85.

The site was surveyed several times. The items published here were collected in the original survey carried out prior to the survey mentioned in the Nadel publication above. Zertal attributed the site to the Pre-pottery Neolithic period at his first visit to the site in 1997. The identification was based on the axes with transverse blows and the arrowhead of Byblos type found during this visit. The data and a comprehensive analysis of the whole assemblage were intended for the first publication in this volume.

This original assemblage, which also includes waste materials and debitage, is considerably larger than the 35 artefacts from the later survey (Nadel et al. 2000). The analysis and discussion here add further details regarding the nature of the site. Despite the fact that this is a surface collection, it includes all

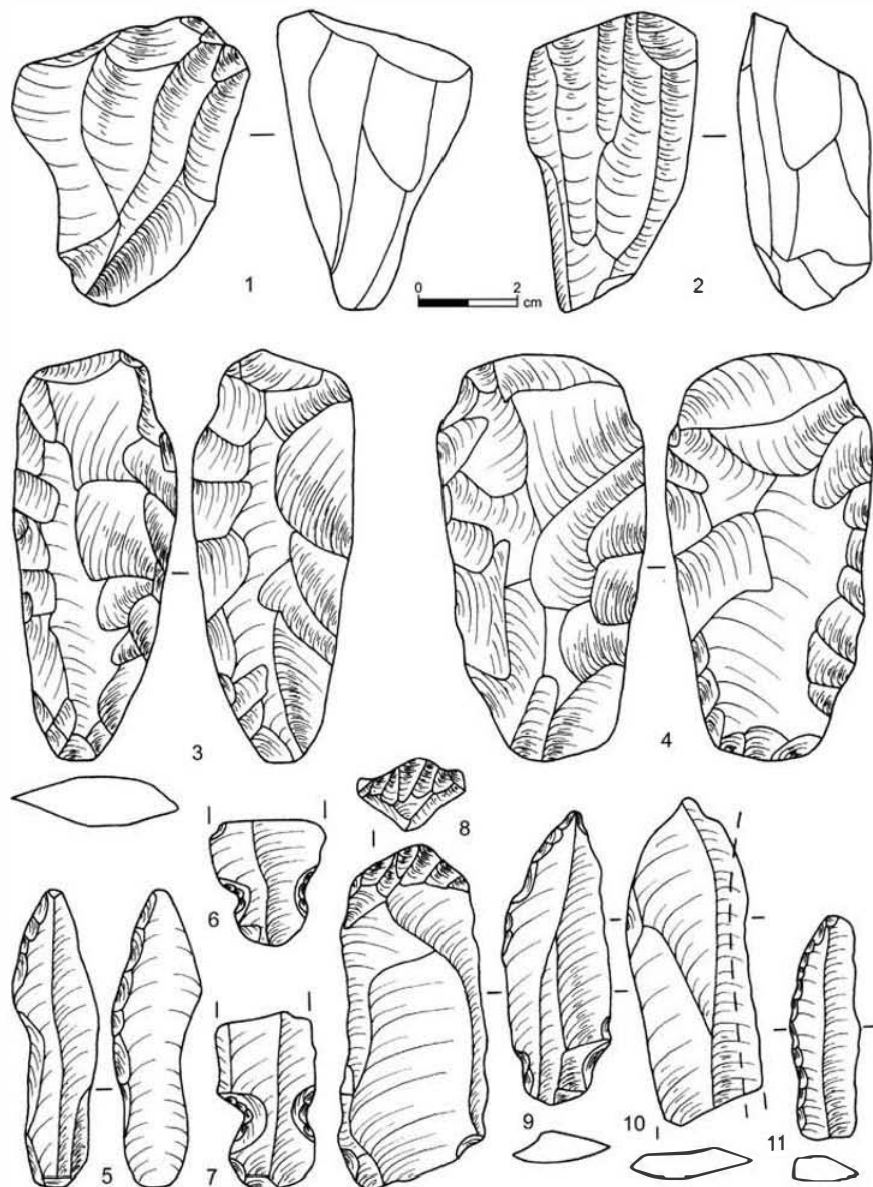


Fig. A22. 'Ein es-Sukhun: 1, 2-Cores; 3, 4-Axes with transversal blows; 5-Borer; 6, 7-Nahal Hemar knives (fragment); 8-End-scraper; 9-Arrowhead; 10-Sickle blade; 11-Backed bladelet.

the components of a local industry – numerous cores, hammerstones, waste, debitage and retouched tools. Most cores are flake cores with multiple striking platforms. They are rather small, indicating the exploitation of the raw material. The large number of flakes indicates a flake-based industry. Bi-polar naviform cores, common in the Pre-Pottery Neolithic B, were not found (samples of these from a nearby area were found in Jericho – Crawfoot-Payne 1983: 276 and figs. 292–294). Also found were two pyramidal cores and two axes with lentoid cross-section and transverse blows (Takhunian) on both faces. The latter were attributed to the Sultanian phase of the Pre-Pottery Neolithic A (cf Netiv Hagdud – Bar-Yosef et al. 1991: 412), but mainly to the Pre-Pottery Neolithic B (Crawfoot-Payne 1983: 675). The Byblos-type arrowhead is also attributed to this period (Bar-Yosef 1981; Gopher 1985). Apparently, the two broken tools, with two notches close to the base, are not broken El Khiam points, but tools defined as Nahal Khemar knives (Bar-Yosef and Alon 1988: 9). These were also attributed to the Pre-Pottery Neolithic B. The sickle blade was not retouched, and was identified according to the sickle sheen. The other tools, with secondary treatment (retouch), are not diagnostic for any particular period.

‘Ein es-Sukhun is an additional site in the cluster of settlements in the Pre-Pottery Neolithic in the lower Jordan Valley. This cluster includes Gilgal (Noy et al. 1980), Geshar (Garfinkel and Nadel 1989), Jericho (Crawfoot-Payne 1983), Netiv Hagdud and Salibiya (Bar-Yosef et al. 1991).

Period: Pre-pottery Neolithic A and B (early stage) – highly reasonable identification.

Site 175 (1). E.P. 138 (1)⁴

Israel Grid 1881/1657, Elevation 180 m a.s.l.; 65 flint artefacts.

Artefacts without retouch: Flake 24; Blade 9; Bladelets 13; Bladelet core 2. Total 48.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Retouched blade 5; Retouched flake 2; End-scraper 4; Backed bladelet 1; Backed blade 1; Side-scraper 2; Truncation 1; Retouched microlith 1. Total 17.

This is only a small part of the very large prehistoric site occupying the entire summit and slopes of the nearby flat hilltop (together with Site 175 [2]).

Period: Epipalaeolithic – reasonable identification.

4 The flints from this site were analysed by Sonia Pinsky.

Site 175 (2). E.P. 138 (2)⁵*Israel Grid 1883/1656, Elevation 180 m a.s.l.; 168 flint artefacts.*

Artefacts without retouch: Flake 69; Blade 25; Bladelet 17; Flake core 6; Crested blade 1; Table core 1. Total 119.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Retouched blade 11; Retouched bladelet 5; Retouched flake 10; Truncation 1; Sickle blade 1; Point 1; Burin 7; Scraper 12; Pseudo-adze 1. Total 49.

This is the larger part of the prehistoric site occupying the entire summit and slopes of the nearby flat hilltop (together with Site 175 [1]). The sickle blade, the pseudo-adze and the general material suggest the Neolithic period, but without more detailed periodization. It is possible that the site is connected to the nearby Pre-Pottery Neolithic site of 'Ein es-Sukhun (see above).

Period: Neolithic – reasonable identification.

Site 175 (5). E.P. 138 (5)⁶*Israel Grid 1885/1655, Elevation 140 m a.s.l.; 134 flint artefacts.*

Artefacts without retouch: Flake 52; Blade 31; Bladelet 5; Flake core 2; Bladelet core 2; Table core 3; Ridge blade 3. Total 198.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Retouched blade 16; Retouched flake 1; Burin 5; Truncation 1; Notch 3; Scraper 7; Perforator 2; Point 1. Total 36.

A large flint scatter in an uncultivated field and a moderate slope descending to Wadi es-Sukhun. This site might be connected to the nearby prehistoric sites at 'Ein es-Sukhun (Site 175) and E. P. 138 (2) (Site 175 [2]). The finds are not very indicative of a specific period. There is one fragment of a Canaanite blade attesting to the EBA, and a point which attests to the Upper Palaeolithic period.

Periods: Upper Palaeolithic – possible identification (part of the finds).

EBA – possible identification (part of the finds).

Site 182 (1). Wadi Ahmar (10)⁷*Israel Grid 1919/1660, Elevation 30 m b.s.l.; 48 flint artefacts.*

Artefacts without retouch: Flake 29; Blade 14. Total 43.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Scraper 5; Retouched blade 1. Total 5.

5 The flints from this site were analysed by Sonia Pinsky.

6 The flints from this site were analysed by Sonia Pinsky.

7 The flints from this site were analysed by Sonia Pinsky.

Only 20% of the pottery was attributed to the IA, and the tools collected are not diagnostic to a specific period. Therefore the dating of the flint is problematic.

Period: Not defined.

Site 183. Wadi Ahmar (3)

Israel Grid 1921/1655, Elevation 60 m b.s.l.

Two blades without retouch.

20% of the pottery was possibly from the Chalcolithic, and 20% from IA II. These two items do not allow identification.

Period: Not defined.

Site 183 (1). Wadi Ahmar (11)⁸

Israel Grid 1920/1650, Elevation 120 m b.s.l.; 150 flint artefacts.

Artefacts without retouch: Flake 104; Blade 32. Total 136.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Scraper 7; Retouched blade 2; Retouched flake 1; Perforator 3; Axe 1. Total 14.

This is a small prehistoric find spot on one of Wadi Ahmar's tributaries. The axe is indicative of the PPNA-B, and the rest of the finds are not indicative.

Period: Pre-Pottery Neolithic A and B – reasonable identification.

Site 184. Wadi Ahmar (4)

Israel Grid 1920/1652, Elevation 100 m b.s.l.; 23 flint artefacts.

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 2; Flake 11; Blade 7; Bladelet 1. Total 21.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Backed knife (?) 1; Notch 1. Total 2.

60% of the pottery were only possibly attributed to the Chalcolithic period, and the rest from late periods. There are no indications of earlier periods.

Period: Chalcolithic – reasonable identification.

⁸ The flints from this site were analysed by Sonia Pinsky.

Site 185. 'Urqaṇ umm Safa

Israel Grid 1908/1651, Elevation 50 m b.s.l.; 254 flint artefacts (Fig. A23).

Artefacts without retouch: Core 9; Primary flake 22; Chunk 27; Chip 33; Flake 59; Blade 19; Ridge blade 11; Bladelet 25; Core trimming element 10; Hammerstone (fragment) 1. Total 216.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper on flake 1; End-scraper on blade 4; Carinated end-scraper on flake 1; Carinated end-scraper on blade 3; Micro end-scraper on bladelet 1; Micro end-scraper on flake 1; Rounded scraper 1; Burin on flake 8; Burin on blade 3; Retouched flake 3; Retouched blade 1; Notch on flake 3; End-notch on flake 1; End-notch on blade 2; Burin-scraper on flake 1; Retouched bladelet 1; Varia on flake 2. Total 38.

The site is located in a south-facing cave above a wadi bed. In front of the cave is a terrace, and the artefacts collected at both locations are discussed here as a single assemblage. Flint artefacts and bones could be distinguished in a breccia layer on the floor of the cave. The collection contains mainly flakes, end-scrapers, carinated scrapers and burins. This composition points definitely to the Upper Palaeolithic. Despite the difference between collections from a surface survey and those of organized excavations, the relatively large number of artefacts allows a comparison to other excavated sites. The retouched group of the assemblage contains 31.6% end-scrapers, 28.9% burins, and 15.8% notches. 45.7% of the group without retouch were flakes, and 59.7% of the tools were prepared from flakes. Although the collection contained bladelets, the nearly total absence of retouched microliths is striking. Generally, the industry was flake-based. Thick flakes with dominant bases, some of them with cortex, were numerous. Similar compositions characterize assemblages from the Upper Palaeolithic from the stage defined as 'Levantine Aurignacian' (Gilead 1981; Marks 1981; Kaufman 1988). This stage is characterized by an industry dominated by flakes, burins and end-scrapers and a low proportion of bladelets and retouched microliths. Some scholars argue that the picture is more complicated, and the period contains more stages, but a discussion of this question is beyond the scope of this study. The assemblage can be compared to Fazeel IX (Goring-Morris 1980a) and Ruġm es-Si'a (Site 86): both are geographically close. The proportion of bladelets and microliths is also relatively low at these sites; and burins, end-scrapers and notches are the most numerous artefacts in the tool group.

Site 185 provides further evidence of human presence during the period, not only at the foot of the eastern slopes of Samaria, but also uphill to the west (see Sites 151/153, 172, 173).

Period: Upper Palaeolithic – highly reasonable identification.

Site 187. Wadi Sadi (2)*Israel Grid 19n/1648, Elevation 150 m b.s.l.; 2 flint artefacts.*

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 1.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Notch 1.

32% of the pottery sherds were from the 1A, and no evidence of earlier periods was found; thus, the flint also should possibly be attributed to this period.
 Period: 1A – possible identification.

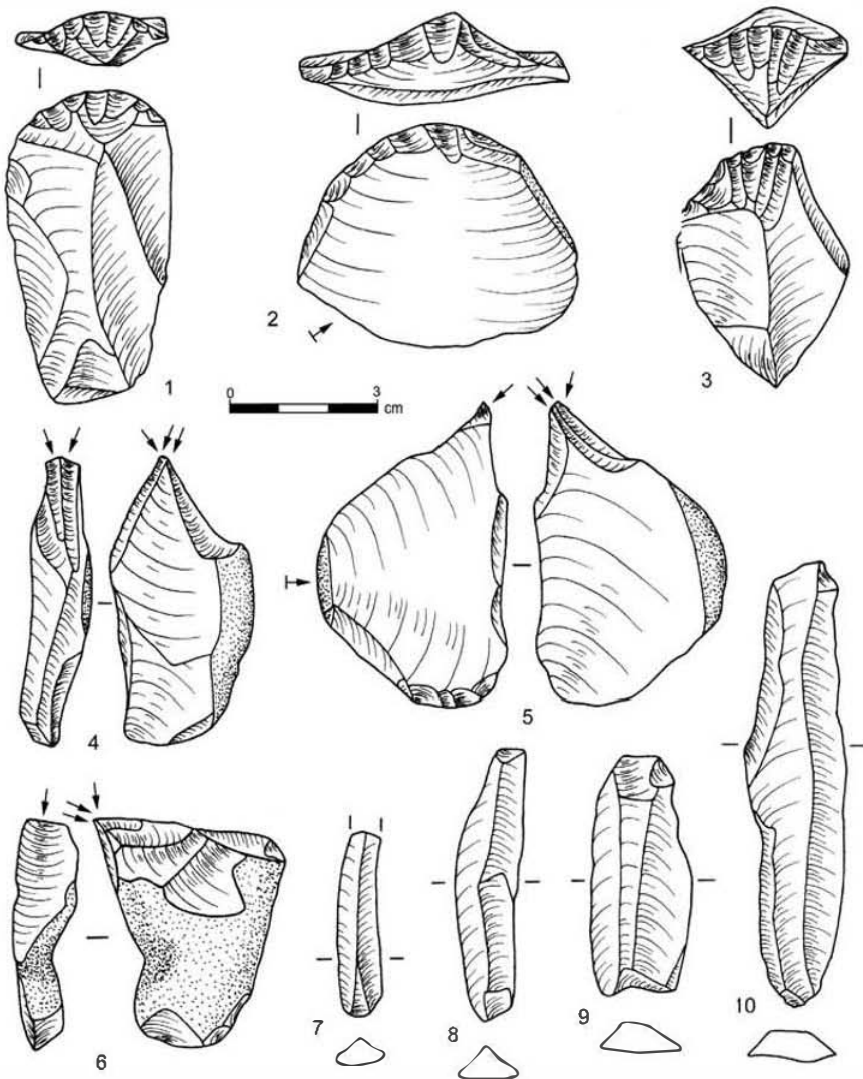


Fig. A23. 'Urqaṇ umm Safa: 1, 2-End-scrapers; 3-Carinated scraper; 4-6-Burins; 7, 8-Bladelets; 9, 10-Blades.

Site 188. Wadi Sadi (3)

Israel Grid 1913/1649, Elevation 150 m b.s.l.; 8 flint artefacts (Fig. A24).

Artefacts without retouch: Chunk 1; Flake 3. Total 4.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Denticulate 1; Fan-scraper 1; Varia 2. Total 4.

All pottery items were from the Chalcolithic. The two flint artefacts defined as 'Varia' are large blades with a pyramidal cross-section and some retouch at both sides of the artifact – apparently unfinished adzes. The adze and the fan-scraper are diagnostic items; thus the flint collection should also be attributed to the Chalcolithic.

Period: Chalcolithic – highly reasonable identification.

Site 189. Wadi Sadi (1)

Israel Grid 1912/1647, Elevation 160 m b.s.l.; 53 flint artefacts (Fig. A24).

Artefacts without retouch: Core 1; Primary flake 4; Chunk 1; Chip 2; Flake 29; Blade 4; Bladelet 6; Ridge blade 1. Total 48.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 1; Borer 1; Retouched flake 2; Notch 1. Total 5.

Four of the 29 flakes have a faceted base, but this trait alone is not enough evidence for dating the items to the Middle Palaeolithic: these were perhaps collected later for reuse. 70% of the pottery were attributed to IA I, and 30% to IA II. In the absence of sound evidence for other periods it is reasonable to attribute the flint collection to the IA. Indeed, the flint artefacts are evidence of a regular flint knapping process but here again, as at most sites of the IA in the lowlands of the Jordan Valley, no sickle blades – the most diagnostic tool for the period – were found.

Periods: IA I – reasonable identification (part of the finds).

IA II – reasonable identification (part of the finds).

Site 190. Wadi Ahmar (5)

Israel Grid 1916/1645, Elevation 160 m b.s.l.; 13 flint artefacts.

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 1; Chunk 3; Flake 4; Blade 1. Total 9.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Side-scraper 1; Burin 1; Notch 1; Micro end-scraper 1. Total 4.

Neither sherds from relevant periods nor diagnostic flint artefacts were found. The collection indicates a regular flint-knapping process which cannot be dated.

Period: Not defined.

Site 191. Wadi Ahmar (6)

Israel Grid 1918/1648, Elevation 135 m b.s.l.; 5 flint artefacts.

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 2; Flake 1.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 1; Backed knife 1.

22% of the pottery were from IA II, but the backed knife was prepared from a blade with a faceted base usually attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic; hence the dating of the artefacts cannot be determined.

Period: Not defined.

Site 192. E.P. -167

Israel Grid 1919/1643, Elevation 160 m b.s.l.; 20 flint artefacts (Fig. A24).

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 6; Flake 6; Blade 4. Total 16.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Side-scraper 1; Notch 3. Total 4.

This site was excavated and dated to the IBA. See Appendix D for further data.

Period: IBA – highly reasonable identification.

Site 193. Wadi Ahmar (7)

Israel Grid 1918/1641, Elevation 160 m b.s.l.; 65 flint artefacts (Fig. A24).

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 8; Chunk 7; Flake 19; Blade 9; Bladelet 2. Total 45.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Side-scraper 3; Borer 2; Retouched flake 1; Retouched blade 2; Notch 8; Denticulate 2; Varia 2. Total 20.

The pottery is attributed to the Chalcolithic, and the flint assemblage does not contradict this dating. Similarly to other sites in this area, side-scrappers and notches were relatively abundant (see remarks on Landscape Unit 30, below), and agricultural tools, such as celts and sickle blades, were missing. This fact could indicate an economy based on herding and grazing.

Period: Chalcolithic – highly reasonable identification.

Site 194. Wadi Ahmar (2)*Israel Grid 1913/1633, Elevation 170 m b.s.l.*

Three flint artefacts without retouch: Chip 1; Flake 2.

A few sherds from the IA I were found, but the majority, 54%, was IA II. The

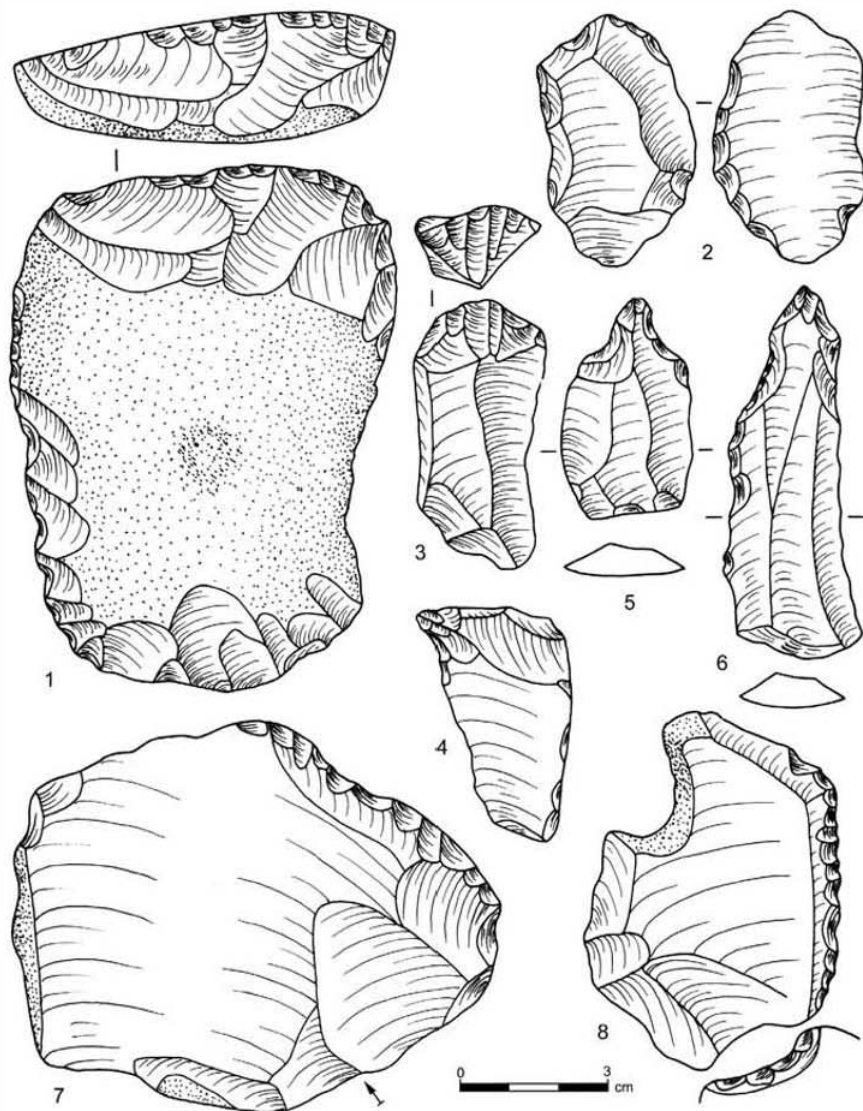


Fig. A24. Wadi Sadi (3): 1-Fan-(tabular) scraper. Wadi Sadi (1): 2-Retouched flake (ventral); 3-End- scraper; 4-Borer. E.P. - 167: 7-Side-scraper. Wadi Ahmar (7): 5, 6-Borers; 8-Side-scraper.

few non-diagnostic flint artefacts do not allow the identification of the period.
Period: Not defined.

Site 195. Urqan er-Rub

Israel Grid 1916/1634, Elevation 180 m b.s.l.

The 40 flint artefacts collected during the survey had not been found when this study was prepared. Three Epipalaeolithic sites had already been discovered in Wadi Ahmar in the 70s (Bar-Yosef et al. 1974; Hovers and Bar-Yosef 1987); these were described by Goring-Morris (1980b), and discussed in detail (Hovers et al. 1988; Hovers and Marder 1991). The site Urqan er-Rub was definitely dated to the Kebaran stage of the period.

Period: Epipalaeolithic, Kebaran stage – highly reasonable identification.

Site 197. Urqan el-Mastarah

Israel Grid 1932/1639, Elevation 25 m b.s.l.; 65 flint artefacts (Fig. A25).

Artefacts without retouch: Core 2; Primary flake 6; Chunk 2; Chip 2; Flake 18; Blade 6; Bladelet 1; Hammer-stone 1. Total 38.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Carinated end-scraper 3; Side-scraper 6; Awl 1; Retouched flake 1; Retouched blade 1; Notch 12; Denticulate 1; Truncation 1; Hand-axe (Biface) 1. Total 27.

Most artefacts were prepared from brown to violet medium quality flint with a thin beige patina, but some had a thick white patina. It is noticeable that on some items with patina, we found retouch without patina, indicating reuse at a later period. Some of the relatively numerous side-scrappers were prepared from Levallois flakes with angled or faceted bases, which is a significant indication of the Middle Palaeolithic period. The active edge of one tool was shaped by Quina retouch. However, the carinated end-scrappers could also indicate the Upper Palaeolithic period. Most of the pottery sherds were from late historical periods, and just 13% were from IA, so some of the flint artefacts could also originate from the IA.

Some facts about this site are noteworthy:

1. A hand-axe was found in this assemblage, attributed partly to the Middle Palaeolithic. This item is usually missing at open-air sites of this period. A single hand-axe was also found at nearby Sites 198 – Tal'at 'Amreh (1) and 203 – 'Monument' (2). This seems to be a local phenomenon which needs further attention and research (see discussion below).
2. At Sites 151/153 - E.P. 195 we found continuity from the Middle to the

Upper Palaeolithic. This continuity could provide the explanation for the rejuvenation of patinated Middle Palaeolithic tools by new retouch in the Upper Palaeolithic, as observed at this site.

3. At this site, attributed mainly to the Middle Palaeolithic, the human

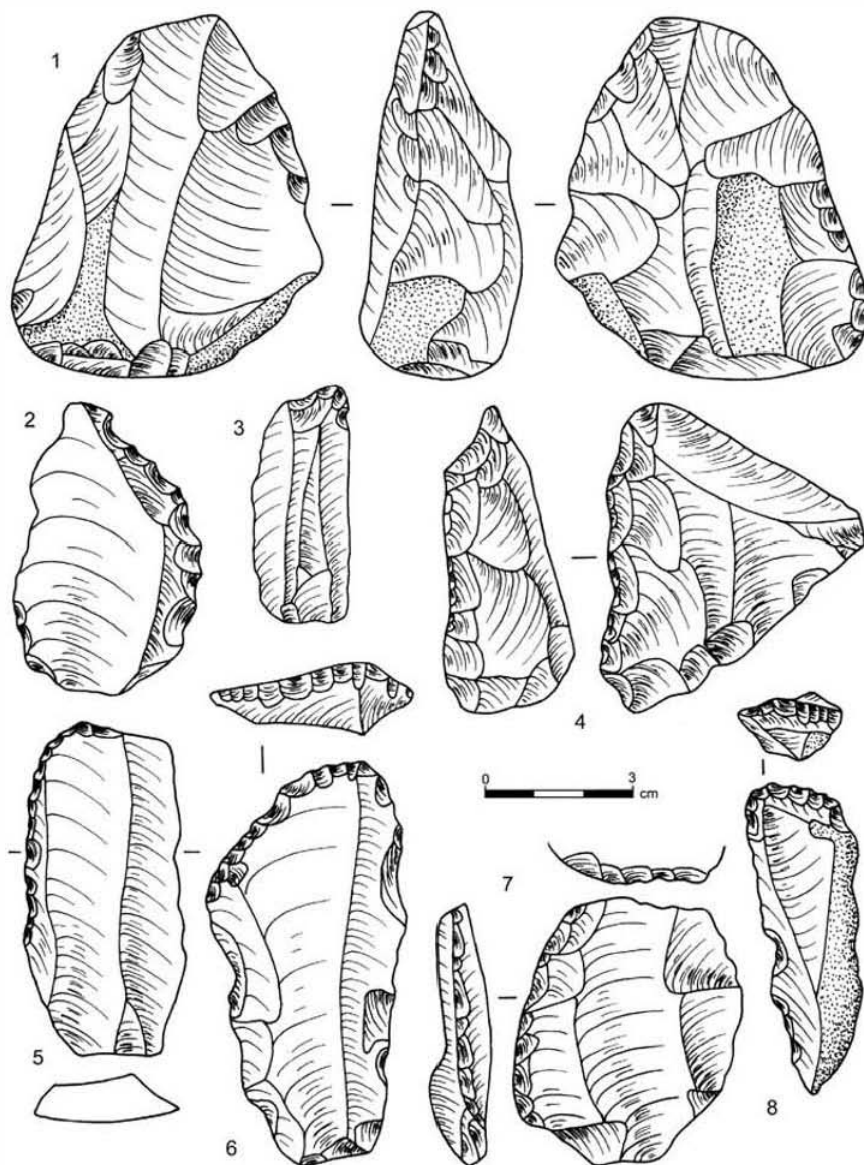


Fig. A25. Urqan el-Mastarah: 1-Hand-axe (biface); 2-Denticulate; 3-Nosed scraper; 4-Side scraper with Quina retouch; 5-Retouched blade; 6, 8-End-scrappers; 7-Side-scraper on Levallois flake.

presence in the IA is documented by flint and pottery. Other sites in Landscape Unit 30, where this phenomenon was observed, are Sites 126, 137, 143 and 169.

Periods: Middle Palaeolithic – highly reasonable identification (main part of the finds).

Upper Palaeolithic – reasonable identification (part of the finds).

IA – possible identification (part of the finds).

Site 198. Tal'at 'Amreh (1)

Israel Grid 1929/1632, Elevation 175 m b.s.l.; 23 flint artefacts (Fig. A26).

Artefacts without retouch: Core (on flake) 1; Flake 4; Blade 1; Levallois blade 1; Hammerstone 1. Total 8.

Tools and retouched artefacts: Denticulated, rounded scraper 1; Transversal scraper 1; Side-scraper 2; Borer 1; Backed blade 1; Notch 4; Denticulate on Levallois blade 1; Truncation 3; Hand-axe (Biface) 1. Total 15.

The site, at elevation of 175 m b.s.l., was flooded for a rather short period by Lake Lisan when it rose to its maximum level of 164 m b.s.l. (Bar Tov et al. 2002). The lake deposits were apparently quite thin, and the artefacts were exposed by natural forces and found on the surface. Similarly to Site 197, located about 1 km away, most artefacts were prepared from brown to violet medium quality flint with a thin spotted beige patina. The hand-axe had a heavy white patina with red spots. The proportions of Levallois artefacts and side-scrappers clearly indicate the Middle Palaeolithic period. In this assemblage, attributed originally to the Middle Palaeolithic, a hand-axe was also found, an item usually missing at sites of this period. A single hand-axe was found at both nearby Sites 197 and 203. This could be a local phenomenon which needs further attention and research, and could also have cultural and chronological significance (see discussion below).

Period: Middle Palaeolithic – highly reasonable identification.

Site 200. Wadi Ahmar (9)

Israel Grid 1918/1648, Elevation 140 m b.s.l.; 64 flint artefacts (Fig. A27).

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 9; Chunk 2; Chip 2; Flake 24; Blade 11; Crested blade 1. Total 49.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 3; Side-scraper 1; Burin 2; Borer

3; Retouched flake 1; Naturally backed knife 1; Notch 2; Denticulate 1; Varia 1. Total 15.

In this assemblage the diversity of the types of flint is outstanding: large flakes from medium quality beige flint, other artefacts from good quality brown flint, and some grey pieces. The functional edge of the end-scrapers is irregu-

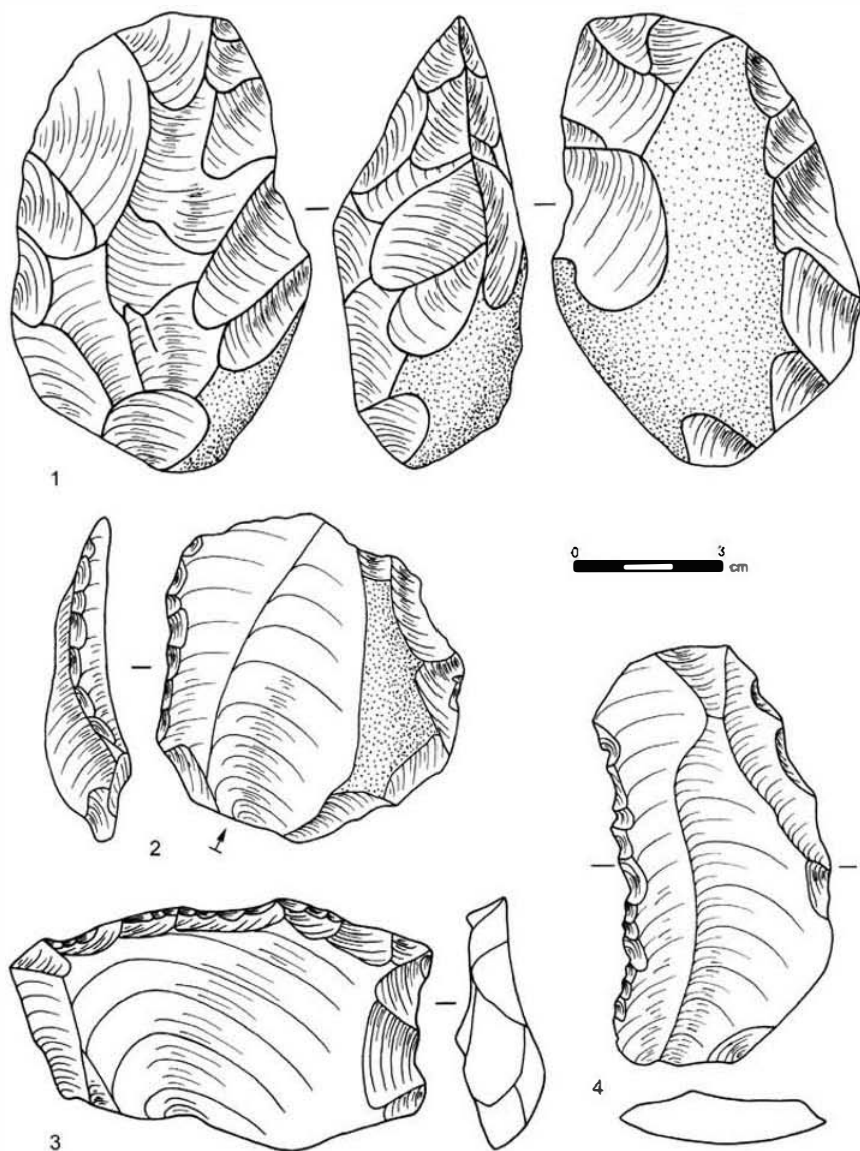


Fig. A26. Tal'at 'Amreh (1): 1-Hand-axe (biface); 2-Side-scraper on Levallois flake; 3-Transversal scraper; 4-Denticulate on Levallois blade.

lar, and these are apparently improvised tools. The side-scraper was prepared from a patinated flake with a faceted base, but the retouch was without patina: apparently it was a rejuvenated antique item. All pottery was from IA I, thus the flint is also attributed to these periods.

Period: IA (general) – reasonable identification.

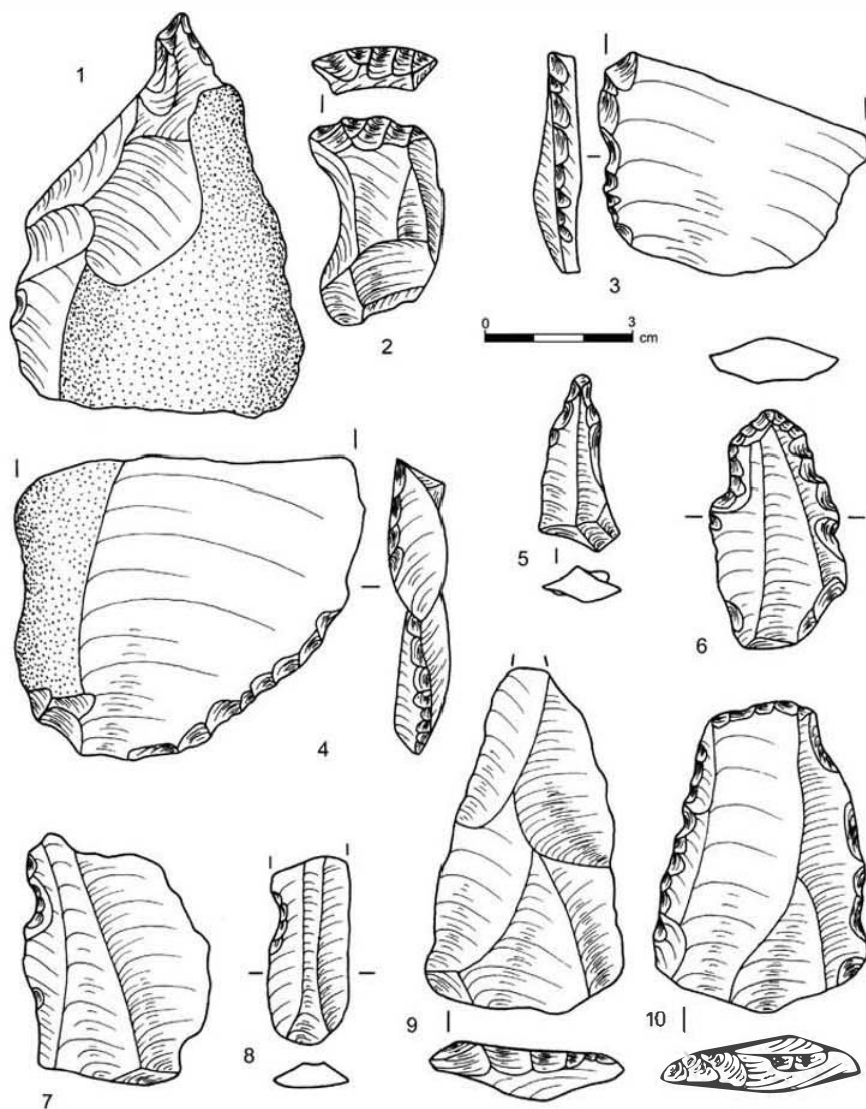


Fig. A27. Wadi Ahmar (9): 1, 5-Borers; 2-End-scraper; 3-Side-scraper. Mugharet Sad Khariz: 4-Side-scraper; 6-Notch; 7-Notch on Levallois flake; 8-Notch on Canaanite blade; 9-Levallois point; 10-Side-scraper on Levallois flake.

Site 201. Wadi Ahmar (8)

Israel Grid 1912/1625, Elevation 180 m b.s.l.; 15 flint artefacts.

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 3; Flake 4; Blade 2. Total 9.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 3; Rounded scraper 1; Notch 2. Total 6.

All the pottery was from the Chalcolithic (and less probably EBA I), and the flint collection is attributed accordingly.

Periods: Chalcolithic – highly reasonable identification.

EBA – possible identification.

Site 202. Mugharet Sad Khariz

Israel Grid 1910/1624, Elevation 120 m b.s.l.; 44 flint artefacts (Fig. A27).

Artefacts without retouch: Primary flake 4; Chunk 1; Chip 3; Flake 6; Blade 1; Crested blade 1; Levallois point 2. Total 18.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 3; Side-scraper 3; Transversal scraper 1; Burin 1; Retouched flake 2; Retouched Levallois flake 2; Naturally backed knife 3; Notch 2; End-notch 1; Notched Canaanite blade 2; Truncation 2; Fan-scraper 1; Side-scraper/Burin 1; Varia 2. Total 26.

Most artefacts were prepared from brown to violet good quality flint with a light spotted patina. Some of the patinated pieces show retouch without patina – clear evidence of rejuvenation some time after the artifact had been discarded on the ground. The pieces prepared by the Levallois technique, some of them with shaped bases, clearly indicate the Middle Palaeolithic period. 22% of the pottery were from the EBA (the rest was from later historical periods) and the Canaanite blades made from light brown flint and the fan-scraper are attributed similarly.

Period: Middle Palaeolithic – highly reasonable identification.

EBA – highly reasonable identification.

Site 203. 'Monument' (2)

Israel Grid 1936/1626, Elevation 140 m b.s.l.; 73 flint artefacts (Fig. A28).

Artefacts without retouch: Core 13; Flakes and blades 22; Levallois flake 4; Levallois blade 2. Total 41.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 5; Side-scraper 7; Burin 1; Awl 2;

Retouched flake 2; Notch 5; Denticulate 8; Retouched Levallois point 1; Hand-axe (biface) 1. Total 32.

The use of the Levallois technique with faceted bases – both the cores and the products – characterises this assemblage. The presence of the single hand-axe is remarkable and unusual for the period, but these were also present at the nearby Sites 197 and 198, which are located on the same ridge. This could be a local phenomenon, but the presence of hand-axes could also have a

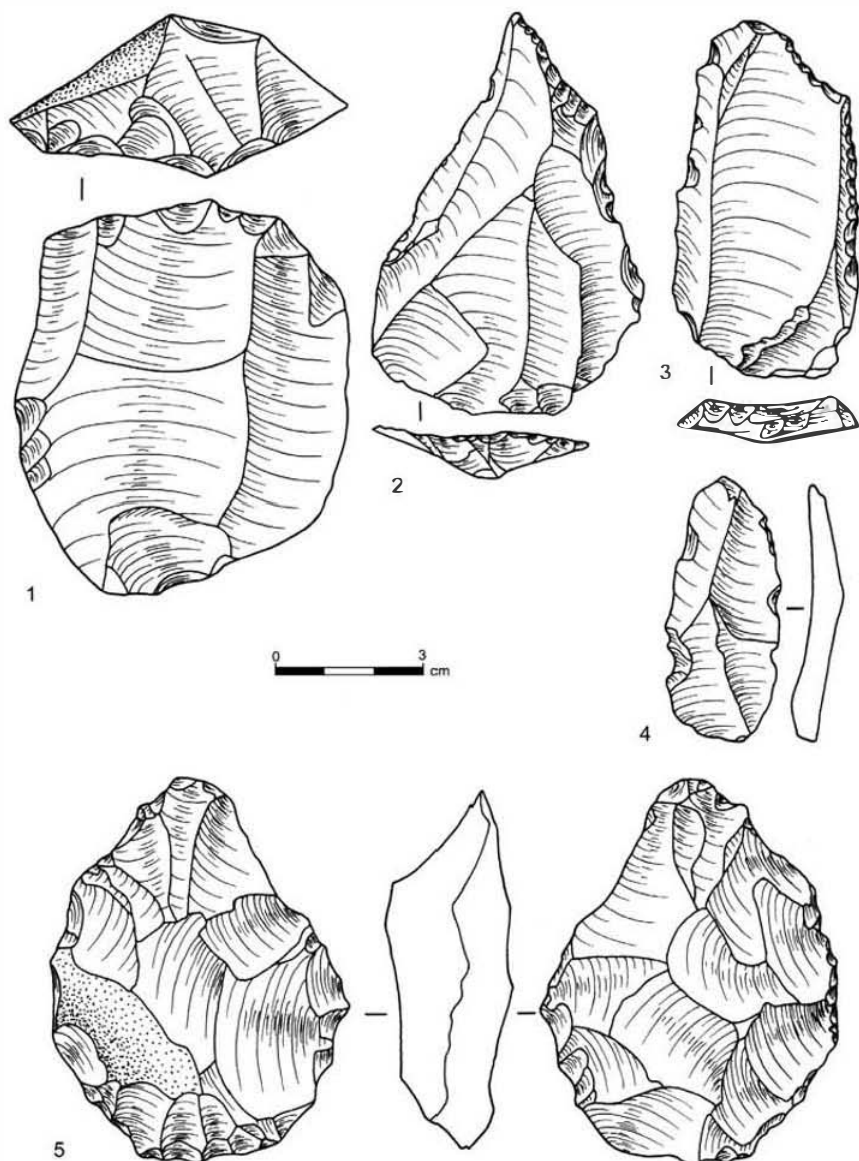


Fig. A28. 'Monument' (2): 1-Levallois core; 2-Retouched Levallois point; 3-Side-scraper; 4-Notch on Canaanite blade; 5-Hand-axe (biface).

chronological and cultural significance (see Discussion below). Originally the assemblage was attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic as highly reasonable.

This is another site in this landscape unit which was never flooded by Lake Lisan because of its elevation. The proximity of large raw flint concentrations and the relatively numerous presence of cores could indicate a workshop for flint-knapping. In order to carry out a comparison to Site 204 some indices according to the Bordes system (1961) were calculated, and the attribution to the Middle Palaeolithic was confirmed: IL=18.5, ILty=38.8, Group III=2.0. See

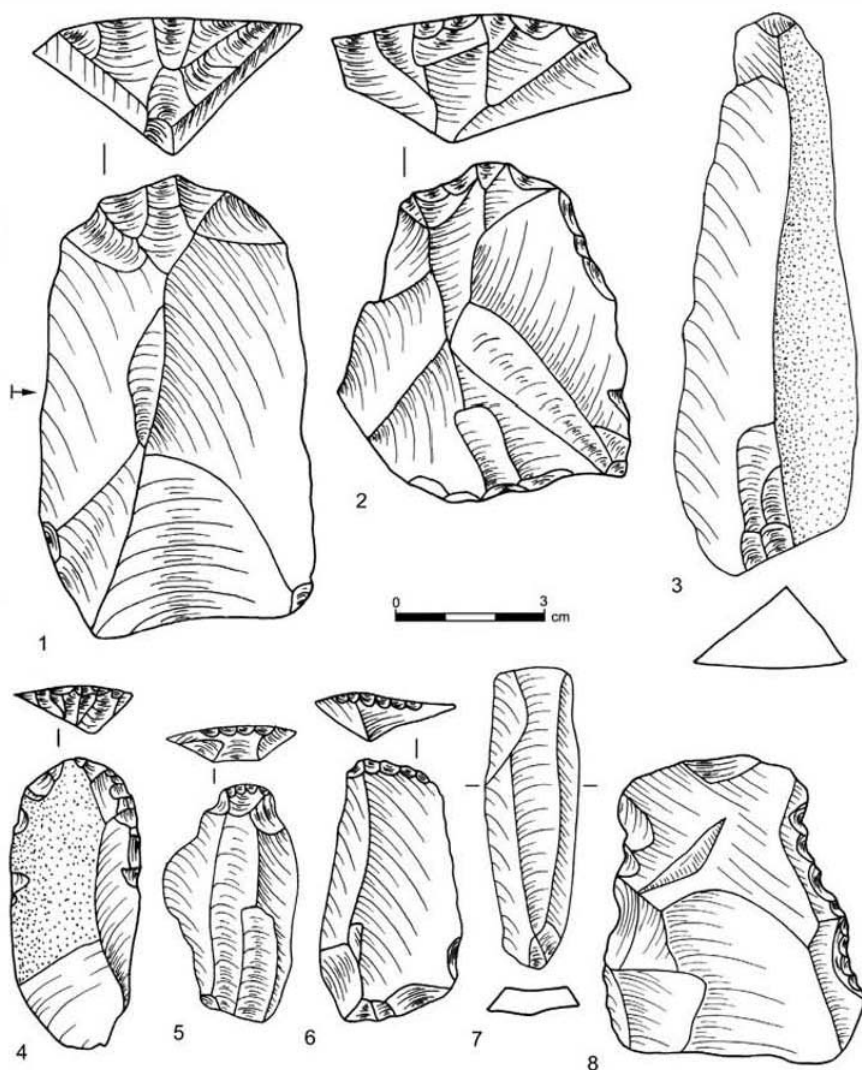


Fig. A29. 'Monument' (3): 1, 2-Carinated end-scrapers; 3-Naturally-backed knife; 4-6-End-scrapers; 7-Blade; 8-Denticulate.

also Site 204 below.

Period: Middle Palaeolithic – highly reasonable identification.

Site 204. 'Monument' (3)

Israel Grid 1937/1622, Elevation 150 m b.s.l.; 115 flint artefacts (Fig. A29).

Artefacts without retouch: Core 2; Flakes and blades 50; Levallois flake 3; Levallois point 3. Total 58.

Tools and retouched artefacts: End-scraper 7; Side-scraper 9; Burin 1; Awl 2; Naturally backed knife 2; Retouched flake 18; Notch 8; Denticulate 7; Truncation 1; Raclette 1; Varia 1. Total 57.

Here also we found that some of the artefacts should be attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic, but the composition of the assemblage points to the Upper Palaeolithic. The end-scrapers, and specifically the carinated pieces, support this assumption. Similarly to the previous site, the indices according to the Bordes system (1961) were computed, yielding the following results: IL=6.2, ILty=9.4, Group III=14.1. The Levallois indices are remarkably lower than those of the previous site; but Group III, the Upper Palaeolithic index, is much higher; accordingly the main part of the assemblage was attributed to the Upper Palaeolithic.

Period: Upper Palaeolithic – highly reasonable identification (main part of the finds).

Summary of Landscape Unit 30

In Landscape Unit 30, at 48 sites, 4159 flint artefacts were collected.

For the first time in Volume 4, 15 sites of the Middle Palaeolithic period were discovered; 14 highly reasonable and one reasonable. Except for Site 198, which is located at an elevation of 175 m b.s.l. below the ancient highest level of Lake Lisan (164 m b.s.l.), all other sites of this period were at elevations from 140 m b.s.l. to 300 m a.s.l. At these elevations the sites were never flooded by the lake and buried under the lake deposits. These sites provide further evidence for widespread human presence during the period in this area, as documented in Volume 2 at Ras Kharubeh (Winter 1996: 670-676).

Special attention should be paid to an important fact: at three sites located close to each other and attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic – 197, 198 and 203 (Fig. A 31), hand-axes, Levallois technique and Quina retouch were present. In each of them only a single hand-axe was found, but the presence in three sites, about 1 km apart, needs an explanation. Since this study was prepared,

sites with similar finds have been discovered and published, providing possible answers, and the phenomenon is referred to in the Discussion below.

Furthermore, it is noteworthy that at Sites E.P. 195 (1) and E.P. 195 (2), many artefacts from the Middle Palaeolithic were also dispersed over a large area.

For the first time surface finds from the Upper Palaeolithic were discovered in areas located above the ancient lake level. Sites 151/153, 185 and 204 were identified as highly reasonable; Site 197 was identified as reasonable, and Sites 172, 173 and 175 (5) were identified as possible. Site 204, at an elevation below the highest lake level, was apparently exposed by natural forces. At the Urqan Umm Safa cave many flint artefacts and bones from the period were imbedded in the breccia layer on the floor of the cave.

Sites 115, 123 and 175 (1) from the Epipalaeolithic period were identified as reasonable. Site 195 (Urqan er-Rub) had already been identified as Kebaran (Goring-Morris 1980a).

The Neolithic period is represented by Sites 175 ('Ein es-Sukhun), 175 (2) and 183 (1), but the unequivocal finds provide further evidence about the Jordan Valley population in this period. Other sites of the period in the Lower Jordan Valley are Gilgal (Noy et al. 1980), Gesher (Garfinkel and Nadel 1989), Jericho (Crawfoot-Payne 1983), Netiv Hagdud and Salibya IX (Bar-Yosef et al. 1991).

Landscape Unit 30. Summary of sites by period. Identification according to flint artefacts			
Period	Highly reasonable	Reasonable	Possible
Middle Palaeolithic	14	1	-
Upper Palaeolithic	4	1	3
Epipalaeolithic	1	3	-
Neolithic	1	2	-
Chalcolithic	3	1	1
Early Bronze (EBA)	1	-	2
Intermediate Bronze (IBA)	1	-	-
Middle Bronze (MBA)	-	2	-
Late Bronze (LBA)	-	-	-
Bronze general (BA)	-	-	-
Iron I (IA I)	-	2	1
Iron II (IA II)	2	6	5
Iron general (IA)	-	1	2
Not defined	8		

Table A6: Landscape Unit 30 - Periods and identification level.

Sites 188, 193 and 201 were attributed to the Chalcolithic period at the level of highly reasonable. Also attributed to the same period at the level of reasonable was Site 184; and Site 164, located at the high elevation of 300 m a.s.l., was attributed at the level of possible. The sites are located geographically close to each other, at altitudes between 100 to 180 m b.s.l. (except Site 164), and were never flooded by the lake. The indications point to a cluster of settlements with a similar way of life. At all these settlements, similarly to the sites of the period in Landscape Unit 29, no celts and sickle blades – tools needed for agriculture – were found.

Site 202 was identified as EBA at the level of highly reasonable, and Sites 175(5) and 193 at the level of possible.

Site 192 was identified as IBA at the level of highly reasonable.

Sites 159 and 160 were identified as MBA at the level of reasonable.

No evidence of sites from the LBA was found.

Sites 126 and 189 were identified as IA I at the level of reasonable, and Site 159 as possible.

During IA II the number of sites increased remarkably: Sites 143 and 159 were identified at the level of highly reasonable. Sites 126, 130, 132, 162, 174 and 189 were identified at the level of reasonable. Sites 114, 137, 138, 149 and 169 were at the level of possible. The elevations of the sites range from 80 m b.s.l. to 300 m a.s.l., well above the highest level of Lake Lisan.

Further facts needing special attention were observed in this landscape unit:

1. Hand-axes (bifaces) were found at three sites: 197, 198 and 203. The sites were attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic period, with the note that this phenomenon is unusual and needs further research.
2. Some of the sites from the Middle Palaeolithic period were resettled in the IA (mainly IA II): 126, 137, 138, 143, 149, 169 and 197.
3. Sickle blades from the IA were present only at higher elevations – one sickle blade at Site 143 (elevation 300 m a.s.l.), and four sickle blades at Site 159 (elevation 350 m a.s.l.). The implications of these facts are discussed below.

Discussion

In this study 7777 artefacts from 103 sites were analyzed. The number of items differs from site to site for three reasons: the number of artefacts present at the site, geological and topographical factors, and the skills and awareness of the surveyors. At sites with either a larger or a diagnostic assemblage the discussion was wider and more thorough. Excavations at any site could confirm, extend or contradict the conclusions of this study.

Ancient sites and the level of Lake Lisan

The initial investigation of the flint of Volume 4 proved that at the lower areas of the Jordan Valley (Landscape Units 27–29), no artefacts from earlyprehistoric periods were found. While writing the Flint Appendix for Volume 2, we assumed that there was a good chance of finding sites from all periods, and the relation between the elevation of the site and the period was not investigated. Indeed, flint products from the Middle Palaeolithic to the Chalcolithic, and also early historic periods, were found in all landscape units of Volume 2. This difference needed a convincing explanation.

Therefore we decided for Volume 4, to investigate the relationship between the elevation of the site and the period. Figure A30 (after BarTov et al. 2002: fig. 7 and pages 18-19) shows that from 45000 to 27000 years BP the Jordan Valley was submerged by Lake Lisan at various fluctuating levels up to about 270 m b.s.l.

Furthermore, for 20000 years, from 27000 to 25000 years BP, the level of the lake rose dramatically up to a maximum of 164 m b.s.l. Later, until 19000 years BP, the level gradually dropped to 270 m b.s.l. It continued to drop to about 300 m b.s.l. at 15000 years BP, and at present it is about 430 m b.s.l. The research proved that at areas which were flooded by the lake, up to tens of metres of lake deposits accumulated and covered the original surface (Bar Tov et al. 2002: fig. 6, table 2). Ancient sites in these areas were buried under the sediments, and there is no chance of discovering them on the present-day surface. Only when the remains were exposed, either by man or by natural causes, they can be found. And indeed, no sites from the relevant periods were discovered

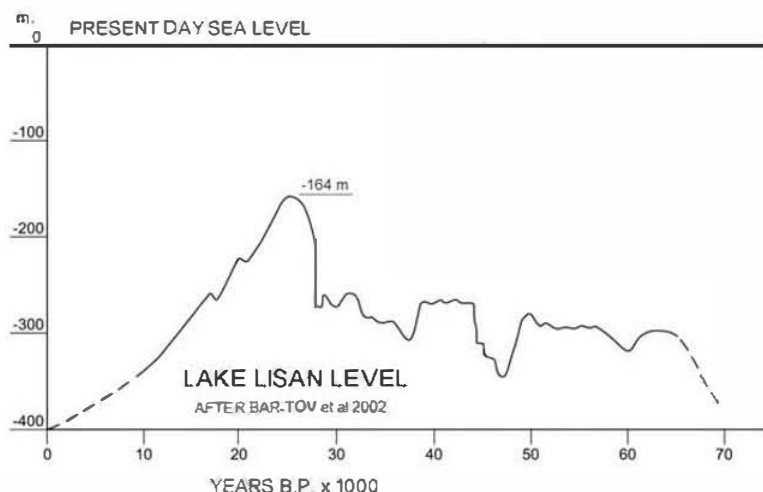


Fig. A30. Lake Lisan level (after Bar-Tov et al. 2002).

in Landscape Units 27–28. In Unit 29, a single site from the Upper Palaeolithic at a low elevation (Site 86, 200 m b.s.l.), has been exposed by recent military digs. Wadi Fazeel sites were also exposed by erosion of the wadi bank (Goring-Morris 1980a). The earliest site which was found on the present-day surface is Site 47, Huzuq Musa, 260 m b.s.l., with an estimated age of about 12,000 years. Thus it post-dated the relevant lake level, and was never flooded.

Sickle blades and ways of life

It is usually quite difficult to draw conclusions from a 'missing' item in a single assemblage. However, this situation is different whenever this item is consistently 'missing' in all contemporary sites in a certain area, while in another area, in similar contemporary sites, the item is consistently 'present'. This phenomenon needs special attention. The sickle blade indicates an economy based on gathering or growing of grain, while the complete lack of sickles indicates a different kind of economy. To date, the lower areas of Volume 4 are semi-arid and in the rain shadow of the Samaria Mountains. The low precipitation rate does not allow extensive farming. An investigation of the climatic conditions during the IA is beyond the scope of this study, but it seems reasonable to assume that the conditions during this period were similar (except for the northern part of Landscape Unit 27 and the higher parts of Unit 30, where sickle blades were found). Such climatic and topographical conditions are apparently more suitable for a nomadic population with an economy based on herding. The phenomenon is already known from prehistoric periods (Kaufman 1992: 169). Apparently the lack of sickle blades in the lower areas during the IA is not accidental, but indicates the way of life of the population. The large numbers of sickle blades found at sites in the Jordan Valley (Site 47, Nahal 'Ein Gev II and the sites of Gilgal and Netiv Hagdud) indicate perhaps more favourable climatic conditions during these periods, or of gathering in the wet areas close to the shores of Lake Lisan, which was at the elevation of 300–320 m b.s.l. at the time.

Hand-axes at sites attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic period

Hand-axes (bifaces) were found at Sites 197, 198 and 203, located about 1 km from each other (Fig. A31). Originally the sites were attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic period, with a note that this phenomenon is unusual and needs further research. In this country, no hand-axes are generally present in the Middle Palaeolithic period (Goren-Inbar and Belfer-Cohen 1998: 206), but a few were present in the strata of the period at Tabun Cave (McPherron 2003: table 3.1). Recent studies from previous digs and new excavations (Tabun cave

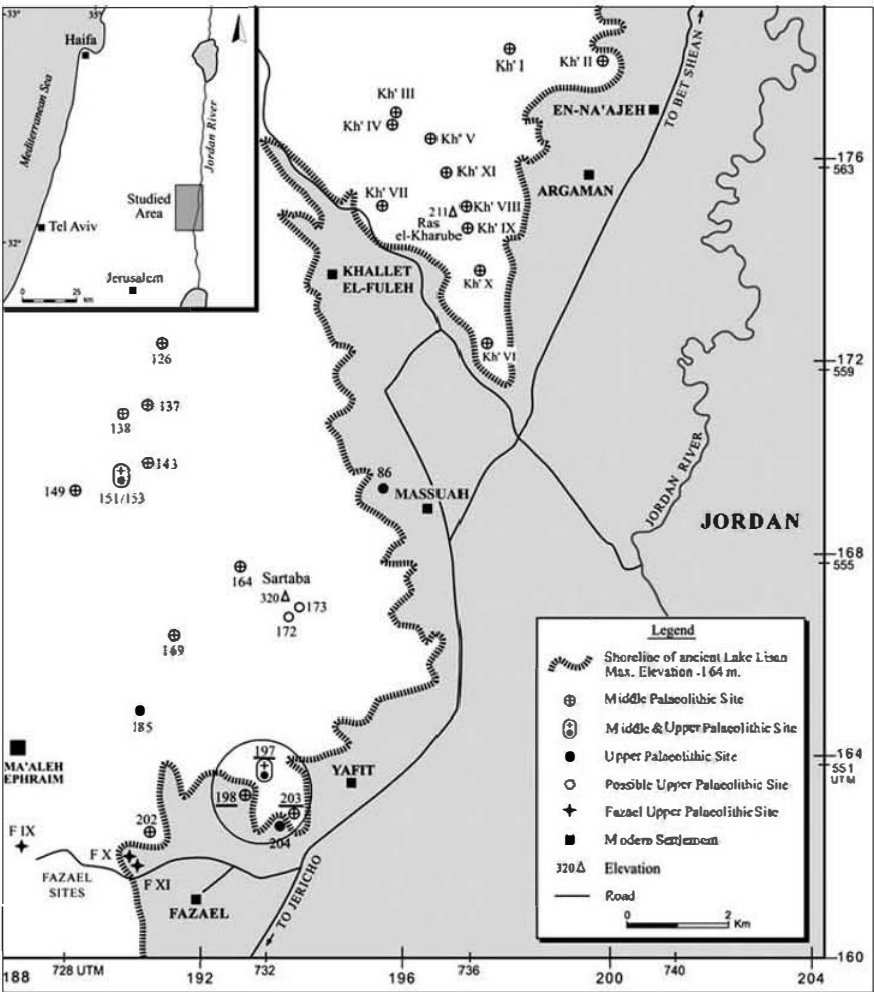


Fig. A31. Maximum extension of Lake Lisan and location of sites with hand-axes (Sites 197, 198, 203 - in circle, underlined).

- Shimelmitz et al. 2014, Misliya Cave – Zaidner et al. 2006; 2012) confirmed former finds documenting the presence of these during the transitional phase from the Acheulean culture of the Lower Palaeolithic period to the Mousterian culture of the Middle Palaeolithic period – the AYCC (Acheulo-Yabrudian Cultural Complex). Their presence here, together with the single side-scraper with Quina retouches (Site 197), and the application of the Levallois technology (Sites 198 and 203), could indicate human presence during this transitional period. If so, these would be the earliest sites discovered by the survey. It would be too far-reaching to draw final conclusions from such few finds, but further research could test this assumption.

Early historical periods and the utilization of flint

In Volume 4 pottery was found at 69 sites from IA I and at 117 from IA II. Flint artefacts were found at 18 and 30 sites respectively. Furthermore, flint artefacts were found at 13 sites attributed to the IA generally. It is noteworthy that flint was only a 'by-product' of the survey, but nevertheless a respectable number of flints were collected at historical sites. These data confirm again that the use of flint tools was a part of the way of life during these periods, because of its availability, ease of production and the efficiency of the tools.

The distribution of sites and their nature in the different periods according to flint finds⁹

- Middle Palaeolithic Period: 15 sites from this period (including three possible AYCC sites) were found. These are the earliest sites discovered in this area, and it seems that they supply further evidence of human presence, as documented in Volume 2 (Ras Kharubeh, Winter 1996: 670-676). These sites were located on the high ridges north of Wadi Far'ah, and the sites in this volume – on the high ridges south of Wadi Far'ah.
- Upper Palaeolithic Period: No sites from this period were discovered in the area of Volume 2, north of Wadi Far'ah. Apparently there was no human presence in the higher region during this period. If sites had existed at lower elevations they would have been buried under layers of lake deposits. In this volume 11 sites are attributed to this period – eight as highly reasonable or reasonable, all south of Wadi Far'ah. Other sites of the period were found close to our area in Wadi Ahmar (Goring-Morris 1980a). Again, sites at elevations lower than 164 m b.s.l. were covered by lake deposits (Bar Tov et al. 2002: fig. 7), and they can be discovered only if they were exposed by human activities or natural forces. It seems reasonable that many sites are still buried under the lake sediments.
- Epipalaeolithic Period: The sites from this period were never flooded by Lake Lisan and covered by lake sediments; thus they can be found on the surface. However, some were doubtless overlooked by the surveyors. In Landscape Units 28 and 30, two sites were identified at the level of highly reasonable. In one of these, Site 47 (Huzuq Musa), a large and interesting assemblage from the final stage of the Epipalaeolithic was found. In Landscape Unit 30, three sites were attributed to the period at the level of reasonable, as well as one site in Landscape Unit 27. Microlithic industries and many rock-cut

9 The picture emerging from a random surface collection of flint artefacts is not complete. For a complete overview summarizing all the data see chapter 'The Settlement by Periods' in this Volume.

installations were found at these sites, but items identifying the phase as in the period were missing. These sites deserve special attention and further research. Site 195 in Landscape Unit 30 from the Early Epipalaeolithic has already been published (Urqan a-Rub, Hovers et al. 1988). The numerous finds point to widespread human activity in this area during the Epipalaeolithic period.

- Neolithic Period: Sites 175 ('Ein es-Sukhun), 175(2) and 183(1) are part of the group of Neolithic sites in the Jordan valley sites such as Gilgal (Noy et al. 1980), Gesher (Garfinkel and Nadel 1989), Jericho (Crawfoot-Payne 1983) and Salibiya IX (Bar-Yosef et al. 1991).
- Chalcolithic Period: Flint assemblages from the Chalcolithic at the level of highly reasonable and reasonable were found at 16 sites, seven in Landscape Unit 27, three in Landscape Unit 29 and four in Landscape Unit 30. In these landscape units the sites were close to each other, forming a kind of local cluster. No sites with Chalcolithic flint were found in Landscape Unit 28. Sickles blades, fan-scrapers, celts and axes are an important part of the toolbox of the period (some of the many samples: Teleilat Ghassul – Mallon et al. 1934: plate 29; Teleilat Ghassul – Hennessy 1969: 18, plate XIIIa and fig. 10; Horvat Beter – Yeivin 1958: 40–41 and fig. 1; Shiqmim – Levy and Rosen 1987: 288 and fig. 10.1; Gerar – Gilead et al. 1995: 245–266). As a matter of fact these tools were present in the northern Landscape Unit 27, which has higher precipitation, at Sites 4, 5, 23, 24, 27 and 31. In Landscape Units 29–30 most sites of the period are located in the lower and arid areas in the rain shadow of the Samaria Mountains, and sickle blades and celts were completely missing. Apparently the population of Landscape Units 28–29 and parts of Landscape Unit 30 were not engaged in grain-growing agriculture, and their economy was based on herding and pasture.
- Early Bronze Age: 27 sites were attributed to the period according to the pottery finds, but only at 11 sites were a few flint artefacts found. The limited number of artefacts does not allow a useful discussion about settlement patterns or ways of life.
- Intermediate Bronze Age: 15 sites were attributed to the period according to the pottery finds, but only at five sites were a few flint artefacts found. Also here the meagre data do not allow any conclusions about settlement patterns or ways of life.
- Middle Bronze Age: 24 sites were attributed to the period according to the pottery collection, but only at four sites were a few flint artefacts found (none of them with highly reasonable identification).
- Late Bronze Age: 13 sites were attributed to the period according to the pottery found, but no flint artefacts were found.
- Iron Ages: Despite the large pottery assemblages from the IA in Landscape

Unit 27, the meagre finds of flint do not allow any useful discussion. The reason for this fact could be the character of the sites, or a selective collecting method during the early phase of the survey. Many sites from the IA (mainly from IA II) were found in Landscape Units 28–30. Sickle blades were found in only two sites, high up in the mountains: Sites 143 (elevation 300 m a.s.l.) and 159 (330 m a.s.l.).

Sickle blades constitute an important part of the tool-box in assemblages of the period from other areas – see: Beer Sheva (Lamdan 1984); Izbet Sartah (Finkelstein 1986: 94); Gezer (Rosen 1986); Tel Qiri (Rosen 1987); Tel Harasim (Friedman 1991; 1992); Shilo (Friedman 1993); Ashdod (Rosen 1993); El-Ahwat (Winter 2012); Mount Eval (Winter in preparation). The consistent absence of sickle blades in all sites of Landscape Units 28–29 and in the lower sites of Unit 30 indicates the nature of the sites and the lifestyle in these units. It seems that during the IA in the lower living areas, the economy of the population was based on pasture, and not on grain gathering or cultivation.

To conclude – the partial picture of the flint finds suggests that during the Chalcolithic period clusters of settlements with pasture-based economies existed in Landscape Units 29 and 30. In Landscape Unit 27, according to the micro-climate, the economy was also based on grain cultivation. Human presence in the area diminished during the Early and Middle Bronze Ages, and disappeared almost completely in the LBA. With the onset of the IA the number of sites increased: first in IA I, in Unit 29, and then northwards and westwards to Units 28 and 30, with a remarkable growth in IA II. In this case also the economy was based on pasture through the ages. Over time, grain growing started in the higher and rainier areas of Unit 27. Possibly the fluctuation of the population density through the ages was affected by climate changes and the amount of precipitation. This subject is beyond the scope of this work and deserves a special study.

Summary

The data in this study originate from a surface survey, and not from regular archaeological excavations; hence conclusions should be drawn carefully. The analysis of flint finds indicates phenomena and periods not included in the general survey, and/or serves as further evidence for confirmation of conclusions of the survey.

1. All sites located lower than 164 m b.s.l. were flooded for a certain period by Lake Lisan and covered by lake deposits. The flooding happened prior to 19000 years BP. Depending on the duration of the period a location

was flooded, the thickness of the lake deposits varies from centimetres to many metres. For this reason all sites discovered on the surface and dated prior the Epipalaeolithic period are located at elevations higher than 164 m b.s.l. Sites of these periods located lower than 164 m b.s.l. were discovered only when they were exposed by human activity or by natural forces.

2. Many sites attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic period were discovered at the higher elevations of Landscape Unit 30. The presence of bifacial hand-axes at three open-air sites located close to each other and attributed to the Middle Palaeolithic period is unusual. This phenomenon could indicate human presence during the transition from the Acheulean culture to the Mousterian, but verification needs further research.
3. The number of sites declined in the Upper Palaeolithic period. Some of these were located on terraces above west-to-east-flowing rivers, and at elevations lower than 164 m b.s.l. These sites were submerged for rather short periods, and the lake deposits were not too heavy; thus the sites were easily exposed by humans or natural causes.
4. Relatively few sites from the Epipalaeolithic and the Neolithic periods which were never flooded were found on the surface. Apparently the picture here is only partial.
5. Differences in the means of livelihood at sites of the same period are the result of different microclimates. In the northern part of the surveyed area (Unit 27) sickle blades and celt tools were found, indicating an economy based on agriculture and grain-growing at these locations in the Chalcolithic. However, these tools were not found at the southern part of the surveyed area, in the rain shadow of the Samaria Mountains (Units 29–30). There, during the Chalcolithic, the economy was apparently based on herding and pasture.
6. Only a few sites from the Early and Middle Bronze Ages were found; apparently the population in the area dwindled.
7. No flint artefacts which can be attributed to the Late Bronze Age were found.
8. Similar to the finds in Chalcolithic sites, no sickle blades were found at IA sites in the southern part of the area (Units 28–29 and the lower part of Unit 30), all of them in the rain shadow of the Samaria Mountains. These tools indicate an agricultural population, and apparently, during the IA, at these sites the economy was still based on herding and pasture.
9. In many IA I sites at the lower elevations life continued in IA II. The flint collections do not indicate any changes in lifestyle, and apparently the way of life was still based on herding. Higher up, however, sickle blades

were found both in IA I and IA II sites. The transition from herding to grain cultivation occurred during the penetration of the tribes from the lowlands to the mountain ridges.

10. Flint artefacts were found at many sites, located close to each other and dated by the pottery to the Bronze and Iron Ages. This fact proves that flint industries were not sporadic occurrences, but an integral part of the lifestyle during these phases. The finds prove the continuity of flint industries until the end of IA II.

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APPENDIX B

EXCAVATIONS AT BEDHAT ESH-SHA'AB, AN EARLY IRON AGE ENCLOSURE IN THE JORDAN VALLEY: 2002-2003 EXCAVATION SEASONS

Dror Ben-Yosef

Introduction¹

The Bedhat esh-Sha'ab site is a sandal or foot-shaped enclosure with a wide surrounding wall. The length of the enclosure is 169 m, its maximum width is 88 m, and its area is 12 dunams (1.2 ha) (Figs. B1, B2). It is located on the eastern edge of the Jordan Valley (Israel Old Grid 1988/1742, 260 m below sea level), 1 km south-west of the modern village of Argaman, and situated below the Umm Kharubeh ridge in the western part of a wide valley intersected by small wadis.

This site is one of a group of IA foot-shaped enclosures in the Jordan Valley (Sites 65 and 92 and Appendix C in this volume; Zertal 2008: site 160). These sites share similar architectural characteristics which are unparalleled in the Levant.

The site was discovered in 1989 by the Manasseh Hill Country Survey. The unusual shape, together with the fact that the Jordan Valley was practically unknown in the IA, led the Manasseh Survey team to excavate the site in order to determine its date and various features. As an enclosure in an arid region, the site was very well preserved. In addition, there were in fact no strata, and the place seems to have been used with few alterations or additions. This situation facilitated the dig and left few points to be clarified. The site was excavated in two one-week seasons during February of 2002 and 2003².

¹ This appendix is based on the latest publication (Zertal and Ben-Yosef 2009), and expanded to include additional data and figures reported in the Hebrew version of this book.

² The area supervisors were Oren Cohen (Areas A, A4), Haim Cohen (Areas A1–A3, B), Sharon Guleh (Area D), Na'amah Yahalom (Area A2), and Murad Tabar (Areas B, E). The Jordan Valley Regional Council helped with the dig, as did the Zinman Institute of Archaeology, Gil Cooper (Argaman), and Avraham Kopilevic (Meholah). Adam Zertal was the scientific adviser.



Fig. B1. Aerial view of Bedhat esh-Sha'ab (photo: A. Solomon).

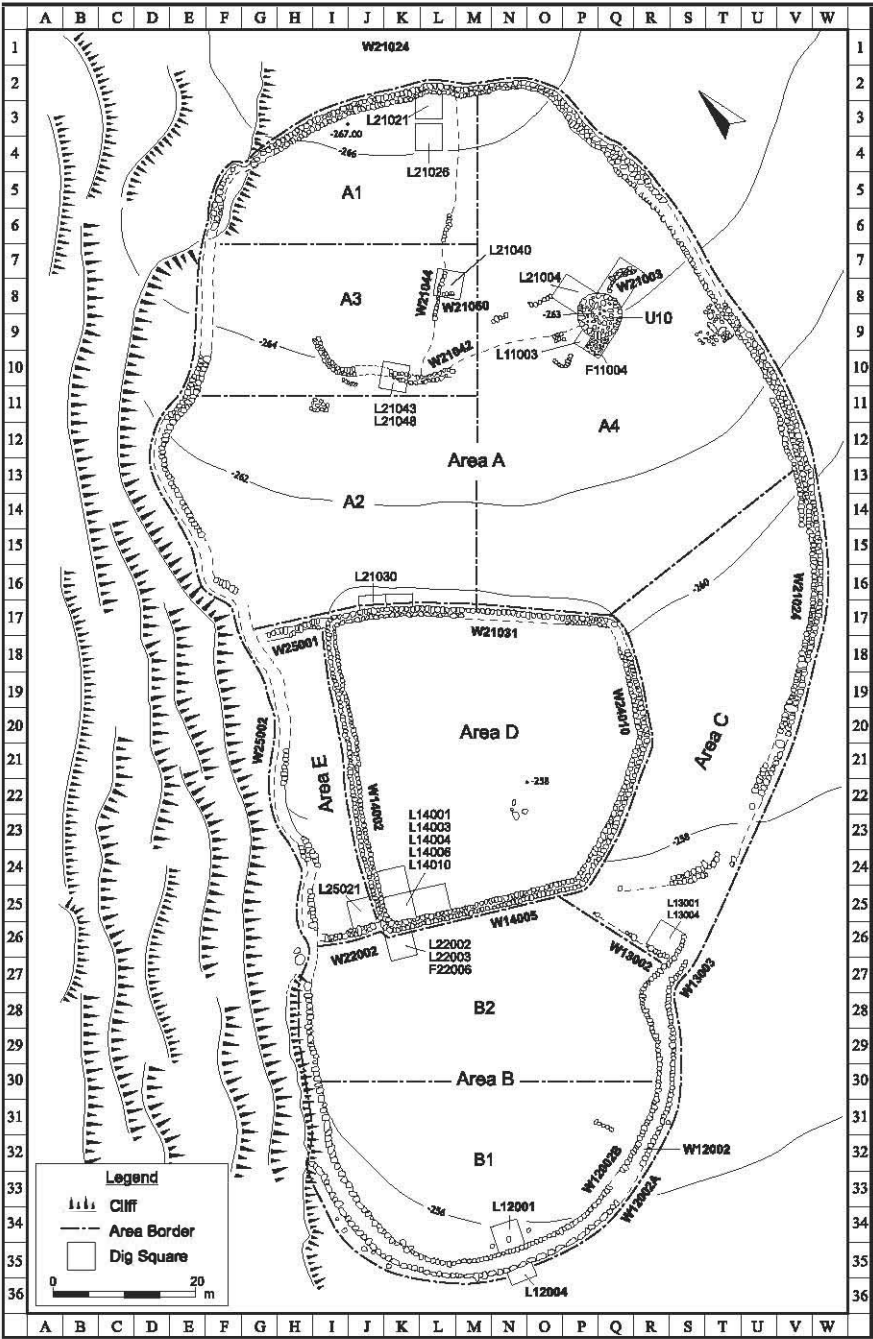


Fig. B2. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – General plan of the site and the excavation areas.

Earlier publications of the dig in this site were in Hebrew (Ben-Yosef 2005; 2007; 2011). This is a more detailed description of the excavation.

The Excavations

The site is an open enclosure surrounded by a 370-m-long enclosure wall built of medium-sized local stones. The wall, about 1.5 m wide on average, is generally composed of two rows of stones, and along a 20-m-long section (U-W/11-15) it has three rows (Fig. B3). The lack of fallen stones around the wall, and the smoothed tops of the stones, show that the shape and the present height of the wall (about 50 cm above the surface) are original. The long western wall (W25002) stretches along and at the bottom of the stony slope. The entire main enclosure wall (W21024) examined in Areas A–C produced an identical picture. The wall consisted of a single course of medium-sized stones, mostly flat and smooth on their upper side and taken from the neighbouring wadi bed. During construction, they were laid in a trench dug in the natural local soil. In the soil and below the patches of pavement, IA I sherds dating to the 13th–12th centuries BCE were collected. During the construction process, the enclosure wall seems to have been built first. Then, quantities of soil were introduced in order to fill up the enclosure and level the interior.

Area A - the 'sole' of the foot (D-U/2-16)

This is a large, open, relatively flat and partially paved area. It is the largest and the lowest part of the site, 75 m long (north-south) and 88 m wide (east-west). Area A is divided by thin walls, presumably built to prevent erosion. Patches of pavement made of small stones can be detected here and there. It seems that the entire area was filled and levelled when the site was established in the IA I. The main feature is U10, a round construction, possibly cultic.

The area is divided into four sub-areas:

Area A1 (F-M/2-6; Figs. B2, B4) is situated in the lowest part of the site delineated by enclosure wall W21024 and 'quarter' wall W21044. Two squares adjoining the enclosure wall W21024 (K-L/2-4) were excavated here. This wall is built of large stones two courses high. Two strata were discerned in the fill near the wall: the uppermost is a brown erosion soil (L21020, L21026) that contained many stones, possibly from eroded pavements and inner walls in the area. Most (90%) of the pottery is dated to the IA I, and the rest is mainly from the Roman period. The lower stratum is made of levelled grey homogeneous soil, and all the finds date to the IA I.



Fig. B3. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab –
W21024 built of three rows of
stones in section V-U/11-15.

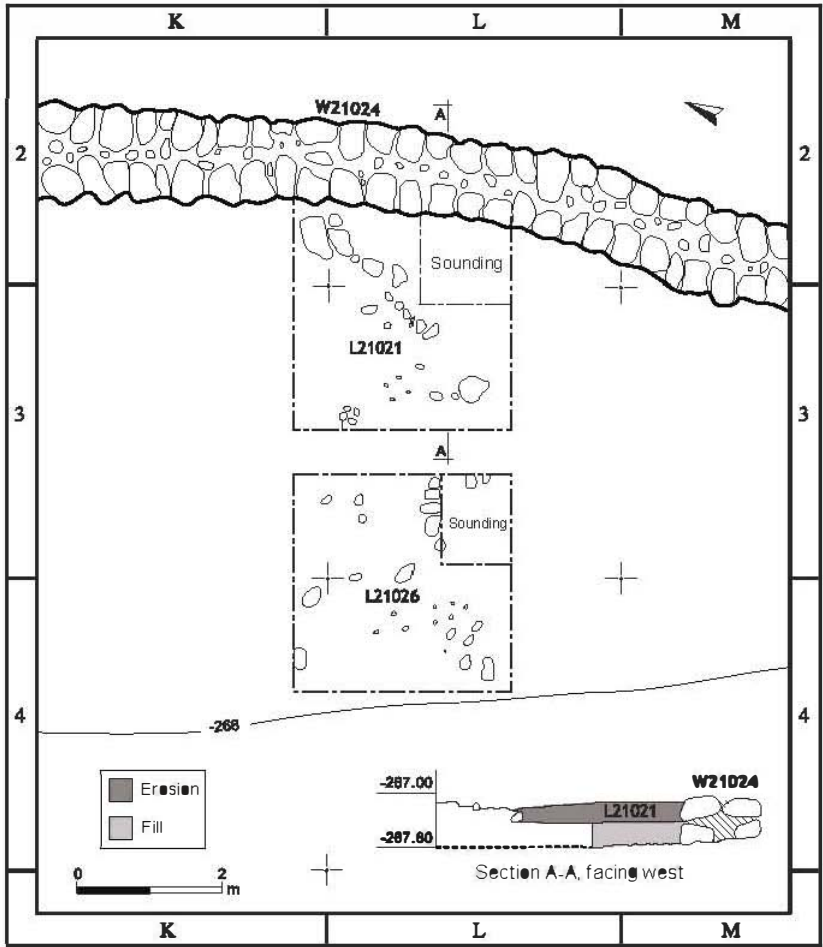


Fig. B4. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – Plan of sub-Area A1.

Area A2 (E-M/11-17; Figs. B2, B5-B6) is situated to the north-east of Area D (the inner courtyard). No architectural remains were found in this sub-area, and a 2×8 m excavation was conducted in the section adjoining wall W21031 of Area D. The outer face of this wall was exposed four large stone courses high (Fig. B6). It is interesting that no foundation was traced to this wall below the ancient surface of the site. A sloping construction abuts W21031 from the

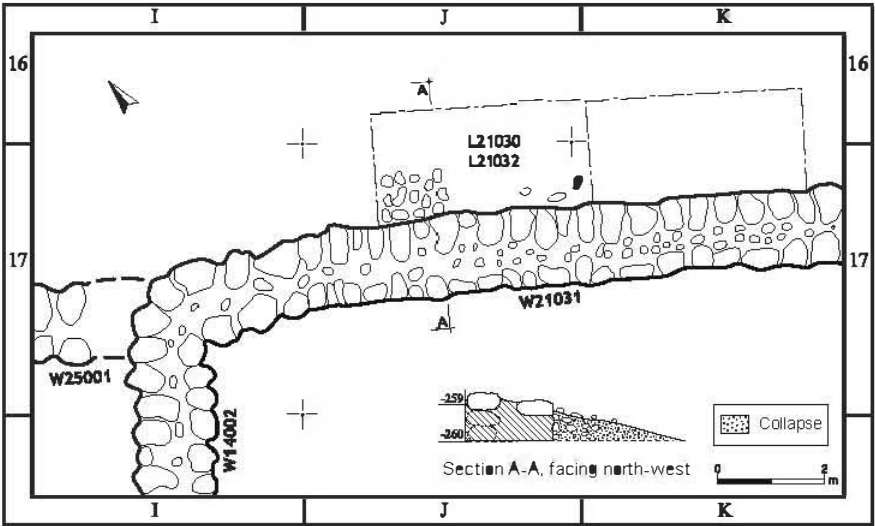


Fig. B5. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – Plan of sub-Area A2.



Fig. B6. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – W21031 of Area D exposed in sub-Area A2.

outside (L21032), possibly intended to support the wall. Mixed finds from the IA and Roman periods were found.

Area A₃ (F-M/7-11; Figs. B2, B7) is situated between Areas A₁ and A₂ to the north-west of U₁₀. The main features here are the thin 'quarter' walls in the middle of Area A (W21042 and W21044).

Area A₄ (M-W/2-17; Figs. B2, B8-B9) is situated in the eastern section of Area A. In the middle of the area, about 11 m from the enclosure wall (W21024), stands a round construction (U₁₀). This stone structure (in Squares P-Q/8-9) was excavated to determine its date and function. It seems to have been built together with the rest of the site. Wall W21003, connected to the construction, leads towards the enclosure wall on the same level, and was probably connected to it. Although there was no physical connection, they have the same design and plan. U₁₀ is built of relatively large fieldstones: the outer row of stones is laid in the header method, that is, the narrow side of the stones is

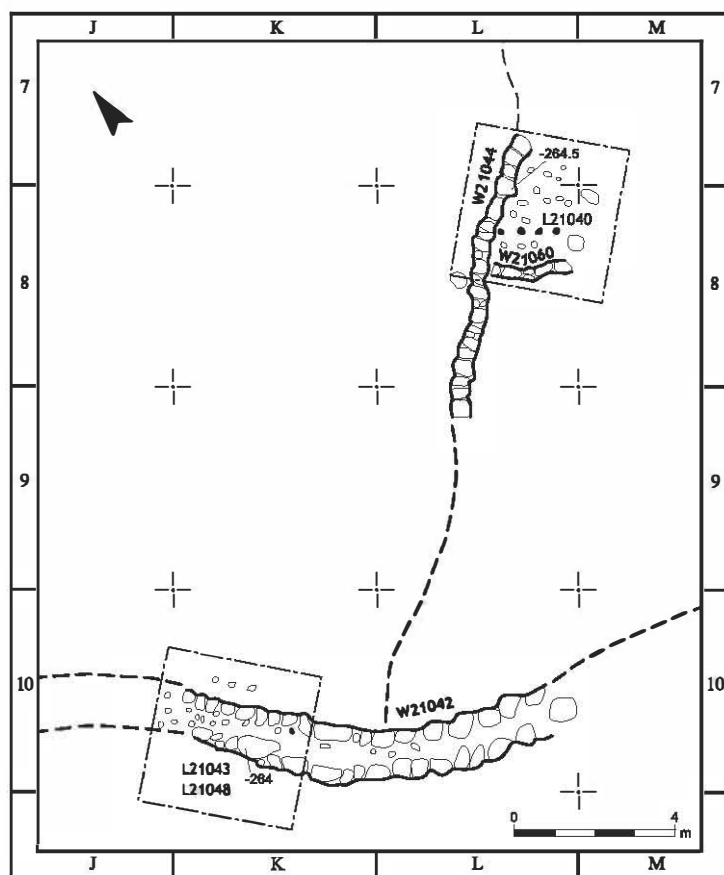


Fig. B7. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – Plan of sub-Area A₃.



Fig. B9. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – U10 in sub-Area A1, looking north.

Close to U10 and on the abutting pavements, 22 animal bones were collected, among them sheep, goat, cattle, and one donkey bone (see below).

The function of U10 is not completely clear. Round detached constructions are unknown in the IA. Round 'Ammonite' defence towers of the *Malfuf* type are known only from the IA II (Glueck 1937: 18–21; Landes 1961:72; Boraas 1971; Zertal 1995), but they are much larger in diameter and are not filled with stones. The closest parallels are the EBA altar from Megiddo Stratum XV (Loud 1948: 78–84) and Khirbet Zeraqun in Jordan (Ibrahim and Mittman 1991). U10 cannot be explained as a tower; it is too low, and does not command its surroundings. Since other functions seem impossible, a cultic use, similar to that of Megiddo and Khirbet Zeraqun, seems to be a reasonable option.

Area B (the 'heel')

This flat area, oval on its outer side, and measuring 50×50 m, is entered through Area C. It is situated in the upper raised south-western part of the site, and its perimeter, except for wall W14005 of the central courtyard in Area D, is enclosed by the built 'way' U11 (Area B, W12000A–B). We did not find any clear ancient constructions inside Area B (except for a recently-built square military enclosure, 25×35 m, which we dismantled) and the main feature is the 'way' U11 (Fig. B10). This 'processional way' deserves special mention. It begins at Entrance C (R/27), and ends close to its connection to Area D (the

western corner of Courtyard D, H-J/26-27). It is slightly curved, about 85 m long and 2–2.5 m wide. The 'way' is composed of two rows of stones 2–2.5 m apart: an inner row (W12002B) and an outer one (W12002A). While the stones of the inner row lie mostly parallel to the surface in a bench-like manner, most of the outer ones are standing. Between the two rows are what seems to be the remains of a rough pavement, raised 20–30 cm above the surface, forming a special paved 'way', slightly raised above the surface of Area B. There are spaces between the stones of the inner and outer rows, which show that it was not made for the passage of animals. The function of this 'way' is difficult to determine because of the lack of any parallels known to us. Nevertheless, some points may be offered. (1) The 'way' cannot have been used for protection or defence, as it is an open construction with relatively large spaces between the stones. (2) As a part of the enclosure wall, it must have been used together with the latter. Here again, the squares dug facing the outer and inner sides of the 'way' present the same picture as the other parts of the site: stones were dug into the natural (and partly imported) soil, which contained only IA I sherds. (3) The special construction cannot have been accidental, it cannot have been used for animals, and the most likely use suggested is ceremonial or cultic.

Two sub-areas were excavated:

Area B1 (N-O/34-36; Figs. B2, B11) is situated in the south-eastern section of the site in the middle of W22010 – U11 – the 'heel'. The masonry of U11 was exposed here. It is built of two separate rows of large fieldstones about 80×60 cm. It is about 3 m wide and the space between the stone rows is about 2.3 m. U11 bends gradually from the south-east to the north-west. Most of the stones of the outside row are standing, while those of the inner row are lying flat like benches. Both rows of stones were only one course high on the virgin soil, and since no stone collapse was found in the excavation it is probable that that was the situation in the IA. It is interesting that no living surfaces were traced on either side of the wall (L12001 and L12004). The excavations on both sides of the enclosure wall revealed a similar picture to the situation in Area A: from the outside an erosion layer accumulated on the virgin soils and no finds; and on the inside grey homogeneous soil, deliberately levelled, with finds dated to the IA I.

Area B2 (K/26; Fig. B2) is situated in the northern part of Area B abutting wall W14005 of the courtyard of Area D. Here an IA I living surface (L22003) was found on a pavement of small stones (L22006) that served as its foundation. Below the small stones larger stones were encountered, probably the lower part of the foundation of the living surface. This surface (L22003) abutted both W14005 of Area D and W22002 of Area E. Most (70%) of the finds above this surface were dated to the IA I, and the rest were from the Roman period. The finds on and below the surface were all dated to the IA I.

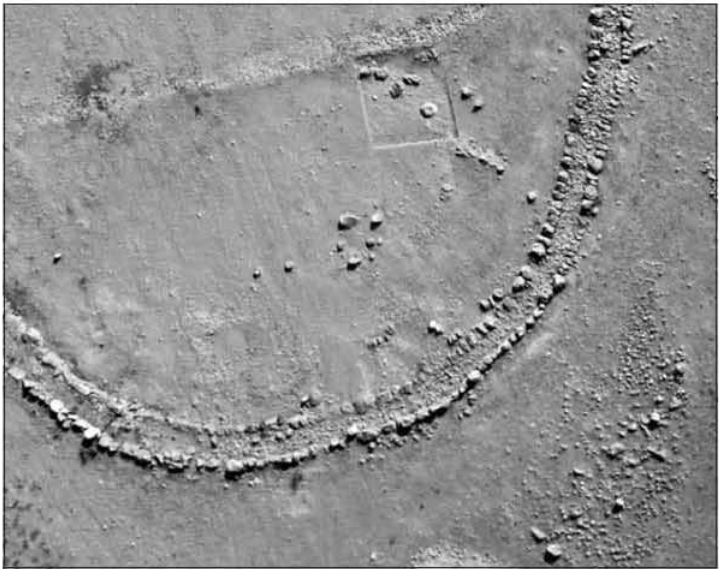


Fig. B10. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – View of the 'heel' and 'processional way' U11 in Area B, looking north (photo: A. Solomon).

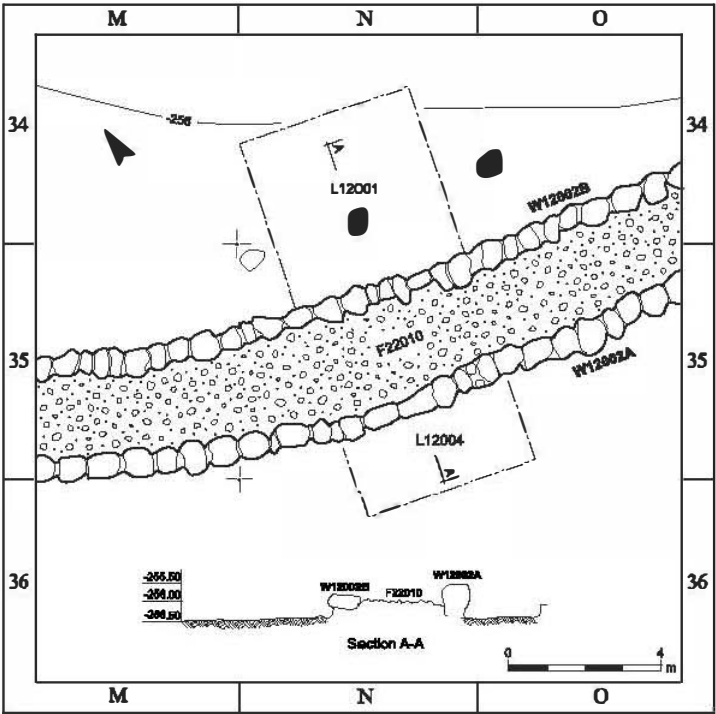


Fig. Bn. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – Plan and section of U11 in sub-Area B1, looking north.

Area C (entrance to the enclosure)

Area C is situated in the south-eastern part of the site at the meeting point of the 'heel' and the 'sole'. The main feature here is the entrance to the enclosure (Fig. B12). This wide entrance (5 m; Q-T/24-26) is funnel-shaped, with the wide side to the enclosure wall. The edge of the enclosure wall from Area A (W21024) turns inwards, and the facing wall W13002 starts from the other side of the enclosure wall (W13003). Although not fully preserved, the remaining parts of the entrance clearly point to its function. The entrance opens onto all three main areas of the site: Area A (the 'sole'), B (the 'heel'), and D (the central courtyard).

Parts of this entrance were excavated in Squares R-S/46 between the enclosure wall (W13003) and the western wall of the funnel-shaped entrance (W13002). The finds below the surface (L13001) were mainly dated to the IA I. Below the reddish-brown soil, parts of a pavement made of small rounded stones were exposed abutting both walls W13003 and W13002. This pavement has similar masonry to the IA pavements discovered in the other parts of the site. Excavation below the level of this surface (L13004-5) reached the sterile layer. All the finds from these loci were dated to the IA I.

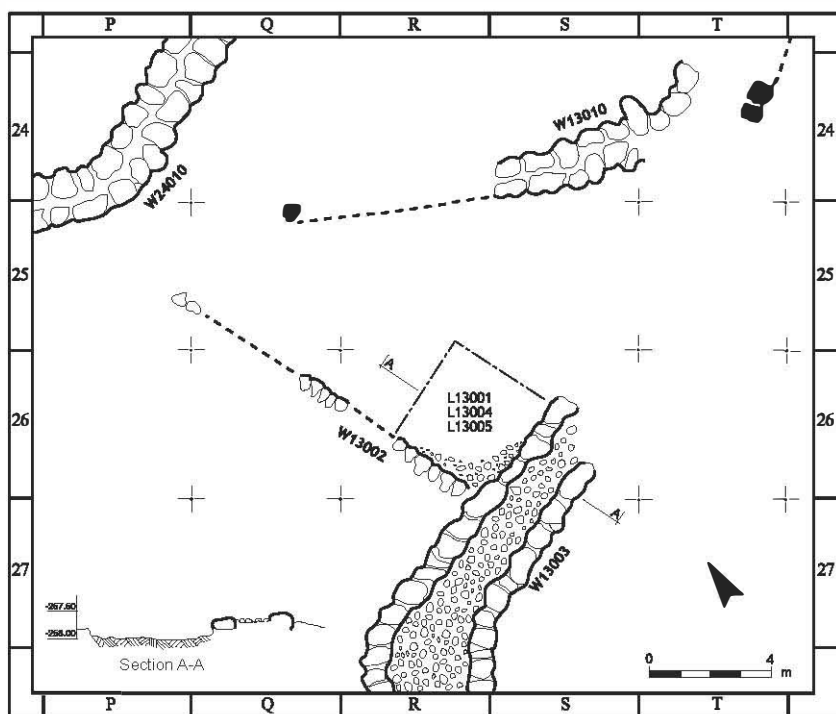


Fig. B12. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – Plan and section of the entrance to the site in Area C.

Area D (central courtyard)

Area D is situated between Areas A, B, C and E. This irregularly-shaped closed unit is surrounded by a well-built 1-m wide wall. It is 46×30 m, with a flat empty surface inside it. Its western wall (W24010) is arranged parallel to, and at distance of about 15 m from, the enclosure wall W21024 (Area C). The courtyard does not stand in the middle of the site: rather, it is located between the 'heel' (Area B) and the 'sole' (Area A). Its two western corners connect to the enclosure wall W25002 in Squares I/26 and G/17–18 in Area E. This connection demonstrates that the whole system was designed and built at the same time, and that wall W14002 of Courtyard D matches the enclosure wall.

Courtyard D is surrounded by a stone wall, consisting of two rows of medium-sized stones with filling inside. A section in its western corner (L14001,

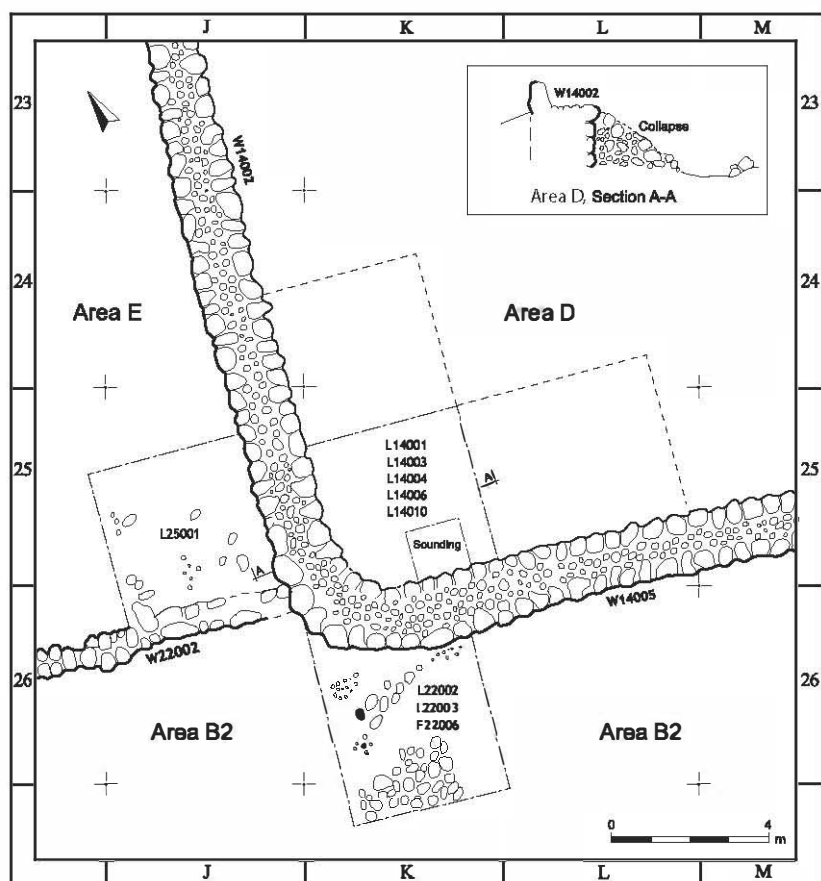


Fig. B13. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – Plan and section of Area D.



Fig. B14. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – Walls W14002 and W14005 in Area D, looking west.

14●●3-4, 14●●6, 14●1● – Figs. B13-B14) revealed that this wall was laid in the same manner as the other walls of the site. However, in contrast to the latter, it is the only wall that stands to a height of 1 m and creates a closed unit. Another difference is that, although most of the pottery retrieved here was dated to the IA I, a few Roman period sherds were also found; that is, these loci were not completely 'clean'. The inner space of the courtyard, unexcavated so far, is now covered by eroded soil, and its use still remains unresolved.

Area E

Area E (G-J/17-26) is situated to the west of Area D. It is a closed rectangular area, about 46×6 m, surrounded by masonry walls (W14●●2 of Area D, W25●●2 – the enclosure wall, and W25●●1 and W22●●2 of Area E).

A small probe was conducted in Square J/25 (Fig. B13) where a collapse was found, probably originating from the adjacent walls. The excavation did not reach the levels below the collapse. The pottery in the collapse was mostly (8●%) dated to the IA I, with some Roman sherds also retrieved.

The essence and function of Area E remains unsolved at this stage of research.

The pottery assemblage (A. Zertal and D. Ben-Yosef)

This report summarizes the ceramic finds of the two excavation seasons (2002-2003). The discrepancy between the architectural complexity and the small amount of sherds is one of the most important characters of the site, so we need to treat the statistical analysis cautiously.

The lack of previous stratigraphical excavations in the western Jordan Valley from the IA I makes Bedhat esh-Sha'ab a key site for learning about the ceramic repertoire of enclosure sites of this period. On the other hand, the lack of architectural stratigraphy prevents us from giving the site a *terminus post quem*.

Parallels were mainly taken from nearby sites in the Central Hill Country or in the Jordan Valley.

Bowls and Kraters:

1. Open and wide bowl (Area D, Locus 14006 - Fig. B15:1) with a thick rim with a rounded top. It may be a variant of the 'Manassite' bowl that dates to the 12th century BCE. Parallels dated to the 12th-11th centuries BCE were found at Mt. Ebal (Zertal 1986-1987: figs. 14:5; 16:2-3), Ta'anach, period IA (Rast 1978: figs. 3:7-9; 5:1; 8:1), and Shilo V (Bunimovitz and Finkelstein 1993: figs. 6.42:1; 6.52:2).
2. Bowl with an inverted rim cut on the outside (Area A, Locus 21020 - Fig. B15:2). Wheel-made burnishing outside and on the rim (not on our example) characterizes this bowl type. The reddish clay contains many small grits, its core is black and the slip turned to black, probably during the firing. A hole was made in the lower part of the rim, probably after firing. Parallels to this type were found at Megiddo IV-I (IA II; Lamon and Shipton 1939: pl. 25:62, 64), Kh. Marjameh (Mazar 1991-1992: fig. 18:21), Tell el-Ful, period III (Sinclair 1960: pl. 22:15), and Lachish III-II (Tufnell 1953: fig. 102:647).
3. Globular krater with two handles and an inverted rim (Area B, Locus 12004 - Fig. B15:3). The dark brown clay includes small grits. Parallels dated to the 10th century BCE were found at Dor (Gilboa 2001: pls. 5.52:16; 5.73:15), Megiddo V (Lamon and Shipton 1939: pl. 161:32), and Tell Qiri VI-V (Hunt 1987: fig. 23:5).
4. Krater with an inverted-straight rim and vertical incisions on the body (Area A, Locus 21025 - Fig. B15:4). The clay has many small grits. Parallels dated to the 9th-10th centuries BCE were found at Tell el-Far'ah (North) VIIb (Chambon 1984: fig. 54:4) and Ta'anach, periods IIA-B (Rast 1978: figs. 23:1; 44:3).
5. Large krater with everted ledge-like rim (Area A, Locus 21001 - Fig. B15:5).

The original vessel had two handles that were connected between the rim and the shoulder. The light brown clay contains grits. This item may belong to a specific type of krater that, according to the parallels, appears during the LBA and Early IA. Parallels were found at Megiddo VIA (Loud 1948: pls. 78:17-18; 84:2), Shilo VI (Bunimovitz and Finkelstein 1993: fig. 6.34:8-10), and Dor (Gilboa 2001: pls. 5.30:12; 5.73:20).

6. Krater with a thickened, inverted rim (Area A1, Locus 21021- Fig. B15:6). Parallels dated to the 11th-10th centuries BCE were found at Ta'anach, period IB (Rast 1978: figs. 12:7; 16:4), and Megiddo VI (Loud 1948: pl. 84:22), and VIA (Loud 1948: pl. 78:14).

Cooking pots (henceforth CP):

1. CP with a short rim and a squashed carinated body that was found during the survey of the site (see Site 65, Fig. 133:4). The dark clay contains grits and the firing is good. This type of CP (Type A), was very common during the LBA, and continued to the Early IA (13th-12th centuries BCE) (Amiran 1969: pl. 42; Zertal 1991: 39). Parallels were found at Megiddo VIII (Loud 1948: pl. 61:27), Ta'anach, period IA (Rast 1978: fig. 2:2-6), Shilo VI (Bunimovitz and Finkelstein 1993: fig. 6.35:8-14), Mt. Ebal II (Zertal 1986-1987: fig. 11:4, 6) and many other sites.
- 2-4. CP with triangular rim (Area A1-3, Loci 12004, 21043, 21021; Fig. B15:7, 9, 11). The dark brown clay includes grits (also shiny). They can be attributed to Type B that characterizes the 12th and the beginning of the 11th centuries BCE (Zertal 1986-1987: 130; 1991: 39-40). Parallels were found at Mt. Ebal IB (Zertal 1986-1987: fig. 17:6, 8), Megiddo VI (Loud 1948: pl. 85:15-16), Tell Qiri VIII (Hunt 1987: fig. 16:4-6) and many other sites.
- 5-6. CP with a thickened rim and a thin 'tongue' that appears at its lower part (Loci 10012, 10021- Fig. B15:8, 12; 4 items). The light brown clay includes grits (also shiny). They can be attributed to Type C, a variant of Type B. Parallels were found at Samaria, period I (Kenyon 1957: fig. 24:1), Tell Qiri (Hunt 1987: fig. 29:12).
7. CP with a rounded, 'tunnelled' rim (Locus 22003 - Fig. B15:10). The dark brown clay includes grits (also shiny) and the firing is good. This Type D CP is very common in the Central Hill Country and Galilee during the 9th-8th centuries BCE. Parallels were found at Megiddo IV-I (Lamon and Shipton 1939: pl. 39:8, 11-12), Ta'anach, periods IIA-B (Rast 1978: fig. 76:8), Tell el-Farah (North) VIIId-e (Chambon 1984: pl. 53:5-10), and Samaria, period VI (Kenyon 1957: fig. 9:18).

To sum up, the site has a sequence of CP from the 13th to the 8th centuries BCE.

Jars:

1. Jar with a thickened rim and a carinated ridge that appears at the lower part of the rim (Area A, Locus 21001 - Fig. B15:15; 3 items). The dark brown clay contains grits and the outer face has a greenish slip. This jar type appears during the 12th-10th centuries BCE, and heralds the 'classical' ridged jar type of the IA II in the Central Hill Country. Parallels were found at Megiddo VI (Loud 1948: pl. 82:8-9), Tell Qiri (Hunt 1987: fig. 32:4), Shilo V (Bunimovitz and Finkelstein 1993: fig. 6.59:6), Ta'anach, period IIB (Rast 1978: figs. 55:1; 58:9-12), and Tell es-Sa'idiyah VI (Pritchard 1985: fig. 9:2).
2. Jar with a thickened and rounded rim (Area C, Locus 13004 - Fig. B16:1). The brown clay contains grits and the firing is good. The item is too small to find exact parallels, but similar rim profiles were found at Megiddo VIIA (Loud 1948: pl. 68:5), Ta'anach, Period IIB (Rast 1978: fig. 55:1), Samaria, Period VII (Kenyon 1957: fig. 55:1), and Tomb 4 at Tell Beit Mirsim (Ben-Arieh 2004: fig. 2.79:26). These parallels point to the 10th-9th centuries BCE.

Jugs and juglets:

1. Jug with a straight slightly everted neck (Area A, Locus 11003 - Fig. B16:2; 2 items). The reddish-grey clay includes grits and the firing is good. Parallels were found at Samaria, Period VIII (Kenyon 1957: fig. 12:11-12, with handles), Ta'anach, period IIB (Rast 1978: fig. 67:5, with handles), Megiddo V (Lamon and Shipton 1939: pl. 6:155, 159-160), and Tell es-Sa'idiyah VII (Pritchard 1985: fig. 4:5).
2. Jug with a straight neck and a ridged-elongated rim (Area B, Locus 22003 - Fig. B16:3). The greyish clay includes grits and the firing is good. Parallels, dated to the 10th-8th centuries BCE, were found at Samaria, period VIII (Kenyon 1957: fig. 12:30), 'Izbet Sartah I (Finkelstein 1986: fig. 21:11), and Tell es-Sa'idiyah VI (Pritchard 1985: fig. 7:22).
3. Juglet with an everted rim (Area A3, Locus 21048 - Fig. B16:4). One handle connected the rim and the shoulder. The light brown clay includes grits and the firing is good. This type (together with Types 4-6) is very common at several sites dated to the 12th century BCE (Rast 1978: 11) with parallels found at Megiddo VIIIB-VI (Loud 1948: pls. 63:5; 67:16; 71:8), Mt. Ebal II-IB (Zertal 1986-1987: fig. 18:1-2), and Ta'anach, period IB (Rast 1978: fig. 11:16).
- 4-5. Jugs with everted rims and handles from the rim to the shoulder (three items - Area B, Locus 12004 - Fig. B16:5; and Area A2, Locus 21032 - Fig. B16:6). The reddish-brown clay contains many grits (especially quartz)

and the firing is good. These rim types characterize the IA I jugs (Zertal 1986-1987: 132). One handle has two imprints, part of a decoration or a mark system that was very common in the Central Hill Country of the 'Manassite' and north 'Ephraimite' territories (Finkelstein 1988: 270-275, 285-287; Zertal 1986-1987: 139-140; Cohen 2005). Parallels were found at Shilo V (Bunimovitz and Finkelstein 1993: fig. 6.47:10), Dor (Gilboa 2001: pl. 5.33:18), Ta'anach, period IA (Rast 1978: figs. 6:16; 10:12-14), Beth-Shean 2 (Yadin and Geva 1986: fig. 9:8), and Kh. ed-Dawwara (Finkelstein 1990: fig. 13:7).

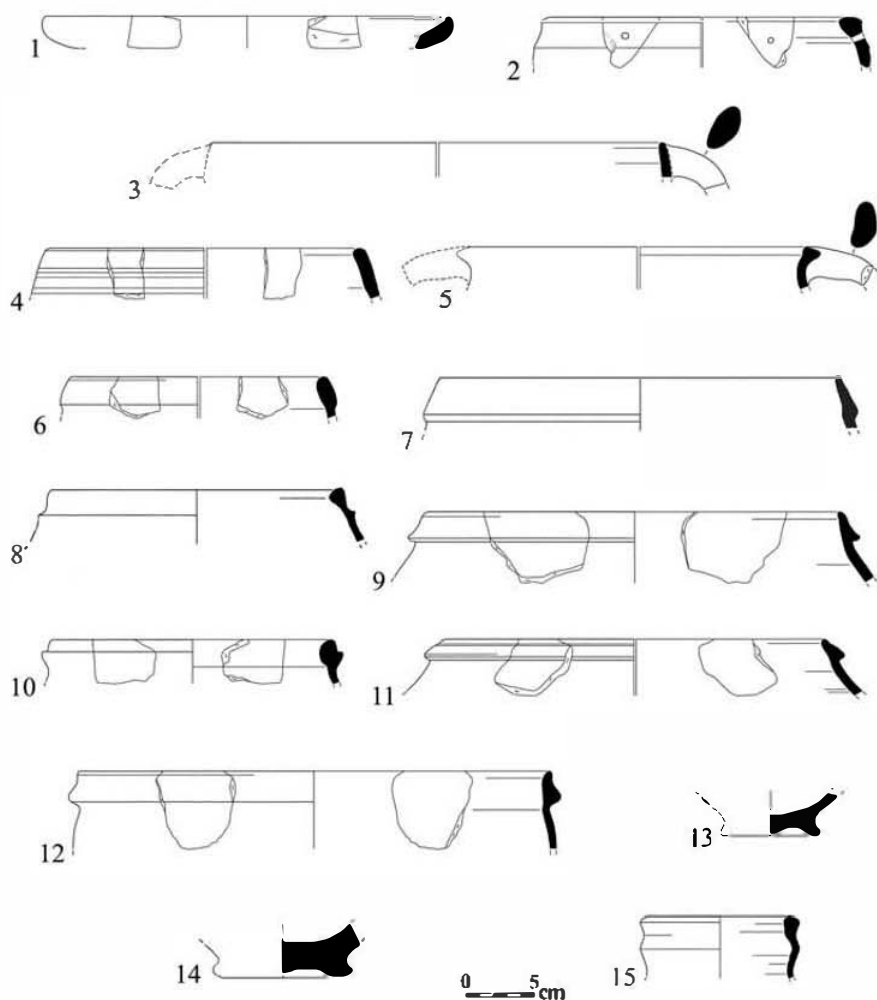


Fig. B15. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – bowls, kraters, and cooking pots.

6. Jug with a triangular-sectioned rim (Area A3, Locus 21●41 – Fig. B16:7). The dark brown clay contains grits. Parallels were found at Shilo V (Bunimovitz and Finkelstein 1993: fig. 6.59:6), el-Ahwat (Be'eri and Cohen 2●12: fig. 12.12:1-2), Tell Qiri (Hunt 1987: fig. 4●:3), and Mt. Ebal (Zertal 1986-1987: fig. 19:12). At Ta'anach this type is dominant during Period I (Rast 1978: fig. 6:7; p.11).
- 7-8. Jugs with splaying rims. The first item (Fig. B16:8; Area D, Locus 14●●4) was made of well-fired greyish clay containing grits. The second (Fig. B16:9; Area B, Locus 22●●3) was made of welllevigated reddish clay, and is characterized by its thin body. These jug types continue from the late IAI into the IA II (8th century BCE). Parallels dated to the 9th-8th centuries BCE were found at Tell el-Far'ah (North) VII d (Chambon 1984: pl. 61: 27-28).

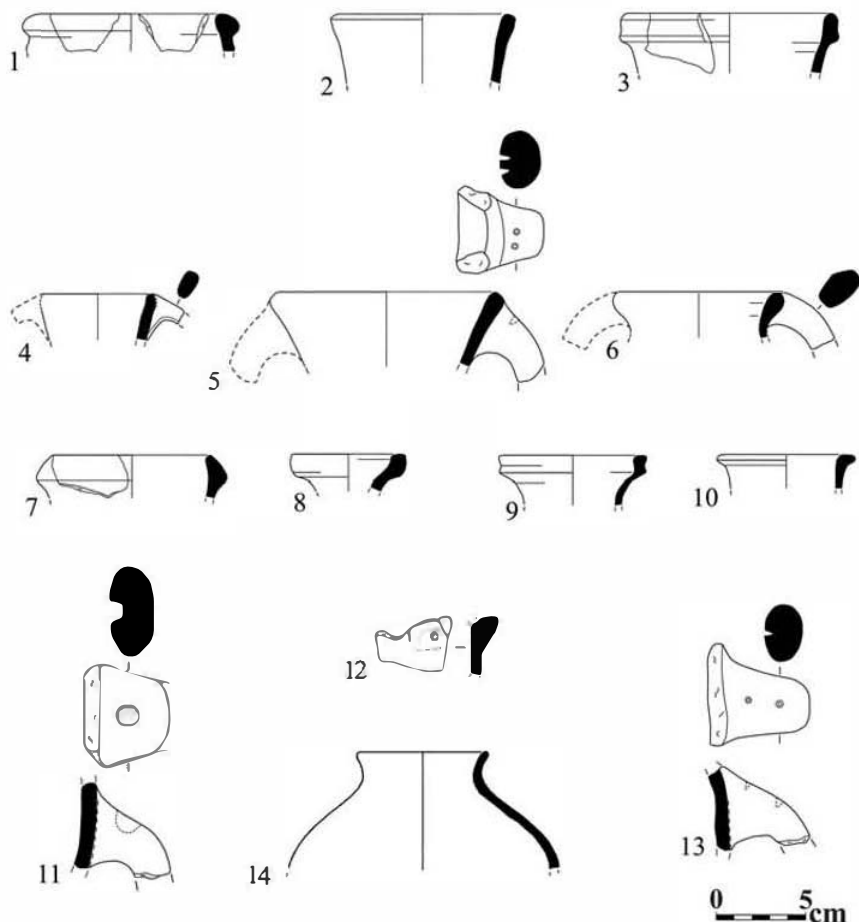


Fig. B16. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – jars, jugs and varia.

9. Jug with a rounded body and a simple everted rim (Area D, Locus 14004 - Fig. B16:14). This type continues from the LBA (for example, Shilo VI - Bunimovitz and Finkelstein 1993: fig. 6.36:18) into the IA I, where it gets a more globular body, like at Megiddo VI (Loud 1948: pls. 81:3, 7; 84: 2, with handles), Shilo V (Bunimovitz and Finkelstein 1993: fig. 6.47:7, 9), Tell Qiri (Hunt 1987: fig. 13:1), and Ta'anach, period IIA (Rast 1978: fig. 24:3).
10. Jug with a ledge rim (Area B, Locus 12005 - Fig. B16:10). The reddish clay includes grits and the body has a whitish slip. Parallels were found at Megiddo V (Lamon and Shipton 1939: pl. 6:160) and el-Ahwat (Be'eri and Cohen 2012: fig. 12.6:10).

Pixoi:

Two items with lug handles were found (Area B, Locus 12005 - Fig. B16:12). The vessel originated in the Aegean culture and made its first appearance during the LBA. During the IA many imitations were widespread in the region and the type became part of the ceramic inventory (Amiran 1969: pl. 96; p. 277). The sherds do not allow precise dating, but we tend to date it to the IA I.

Varia:

- 1-2. Ring bases of a jug or a krater (Area D, Locus 14004; Locus 12005 - Fig. B15:13-14). The greyish brown clay includes grits and the firing is good. Similar bases are very common during the IA I and continue at least to the 10th century BCE. Parallels were found at Ta'anach, Period IIB (Rast 1978: figs. 37:1-2; 38:1), Mt. Ebal II (Zertal 1986-1987: fig. 13:2-3), Nahal La'anah (Cohen and Cohen-Amin 2004: fig. 48:9) and Nahal Elah (Cohen and Cohen-Amin 2004: fig. 64:12).
3. Jar handle with a deep fingerprint (Area B, Locus 12004 - Fig. B16:11). The light brown clay contains grits and the outer face has traces of white-washing. Finger impressions are common during the IA, especially on jar handles.
4. Jar handle with two vertical incisions (Area A, Locus 21001 - Fig. B16:13). Light brown clay with grits. Incisions on handles and rims, especially of pithoi, jars and jugs, are very common during the IA I (see discussion on jug types 4-5).

Summary and conclusions:

This summary will deal only with the IA I pottery, as the indicative sherds from the Roman period are very scarce and point to little activity at the site between the 1st and the 3rd-4th centuries CE.

Pottery is a very important reflector of life in every ancient site. Through it one can date the site relatively and learn about its economic and sociological aspects.

Bedhat esh-Sha'ab is the first IA I site to be excavated and published in the western Jordan valley. The results of the Manasseh Hill Country Survey point to the singularity of the Jordan valley (see the Introductions to this volume), and this is also reflected in the ceramic assemblage. The unique character of the site (a large enclosure that served for ecclesiastical or even cultic purposes) must be taken into account in its analysis. The archaeological excavations conducted at Mt. Ebal, el-Ahwat and other sites show that every site has its 'ceramic signature' that must be deciphered.

During the excavations at Bedhat esh-Sha'ab, 904 sherds were found and classified. We will try, through this ceramic signature to answer the following questions:

1. When was the site established?
2. When did the main activities occur, and for how long?
3. What were the main vessels and in which areas?
4. Was the site abandoned? If so –when?
5. What was the economy of the site and the character of the activities performed?

The dating is mainly based according to the CP, which seems to be the preferable device for inter-period dating. Mazar (1981) proposed the classification of the CP into Types A (13th century BCE), and B (12th century BCE). Zertal (1991) followed him and suggested two additional types: C (11th-10th centuries BCE) and D (IA II).

Two Type A CPs were found in the survey at Bedhat esh-Sha'ab, eight of Type B, and eight of Type C. Some Type D rims were also found.

According to the ceramic analysis we propose the following conclusions:

1. The site was established at the end of the 13th century BCE or at the beginning of the 12th century BCE. Since there are no traces of earlier architectonic stages, it seems that the site was built as a whole according to a plan. This conclusion is based on similar ceramic inventories from Mt. Ebal II and Shilo VI-V: CP Type A, the 'Manassite' bowls, and especially the one-handled jugs with imprinted decoration. There are also some vessel types that derive from the LBA ceramic heritage.
2. The site continued to function, probably continuously, during the 11th-10th centuries BCE, as testified by CP Types B and C, the kraters and jugs. There are few sherds dated to the 9th-8th centuries BCE, and we can assume that at that time the activity at the site was reduced.

3. The lack of architectural phases, the small amount of ceramics, and the fact that the vessel types last for a long time, may indicate a place of pilgrimage.
4. We propose that the site was established around 1200 BCE, very close to the one on Mt. Ebal. It was active until the end of the 8th century BCE, and then abandoned. It was occupied sporadically, and there was probably not a permanent settlement here.

The Roman-Byzantine sherds point to few additional later activities here during these periods³.

The types of pottery and their spatial distribution are important in the analysis of the site. 139 of the 904 IA sherds (15%) are indicative. The vessel classification is as follows:

	Bowls	CP	Kraters	Jars	Jugs	Juglets	Pixoi	Total
No.	4	74	7	18	30	4	2	139
% of total	3	53	5	13	22	3	1	100

Table B1. The IA pottery types.

Table B1 shows some of the site's main characteristics:

1. The complete absence of pithoi, and especially collared rim pithoi, that characterise the IA I culture in the Central Hill Country, is striking.
2. There is only a small number of bowls and kraters.
3. The numbers of the CPs and jugs are remarkably high. Even if we take the lack of consistency into account (body sherds of CPs were also counted), the high rates of these two vessels are still remarkable. The CP is the dominant vessel type at the site: 74 sherds were found, many of them in Areas A and A1 (16 items). 30 jugs were also found, most of them in Areas B and B1 (12 items). 18 jars were found, and there is no dominant type or area where many of them were found. Bowls (4 sherds) were found mostly in Area A1 (3). Small numbers of kraters (7), juglets (4), and pixoi (2) were also found.
4. Many CP sherds were found in Area A, especially around the round construction U10. It seems that feasting activity took place close to this structure. In Area B, close to courtyard D, activity using jugs took place.

³ Several sherds (including five indicatives), were dated to the 1st and 4th centuries CE. We thank Ms. Michal Oren-Paskal of the Recanati Institute for Maritime Studies, University of Haifa, for her help in identifying the pottery from the later periods.

The following table shows a comparison between the site assemblages and relevant IA sites in the region:

	Bowls	Kraters	CP	Jars	Pithoi	Jugs
Mt. Ebal II	14	6	5	12	28	19
Giloh	9	0.5	26	16	35	19
'Izbet Sartah	23	-	13	18 (with pithoi)	8	
el-Ahwat ⁴	10	14	7	8	3	15
Shilo V	7 (with kraters)		6	15	12	18
Yafit (3) ⁵	-	5	45	-	-	30
Bedhat esh-Sha'ab ⁶	3	5	53	13	-	22

Table B2. Comparison to related IA sites in the region.

The lack of unity between the sites stems mainly from the absence of clear criteria in classifying sherds into vessel types, but we can propose some conclusions:

- Bowls constitute 10–23% in the other sites. This vessel type was mainly used for eating and drinking. Its low proportion at Bedhat esh-Sha'ab, in contrast to the high proportion of CPs, suggests that proper eating/feasting did not take place inside the site.
- The proportion of CPs at Bedhat esh-Sha'ab (53%) is much higher than the average of the other sites (15–20%). The CP is the only cooking vessel of the 'Hill Country culture' of the IA I. The high proportion of these vessels at Bedhat esh-Sha'ab indicates very intensive cooking activity in Area A, and especially around U10, probably connected with some kind of cultic activity.
- The number and percentage of jars is similar to the other sites in the region.
- The absence of pithoi at the site is striking, and possibly connected to their possible function as the main water container of the period.
- The proportion of jugs at the site is a little higher than in other sites. The 'jug culture' mainly characterizes the Hill Country areas, and most of the imprints were found on jug handles (Cohen 2005).
- The 'ceramic signature', with the exception of the absence of collared rim pithoi, the small amount of bowls, and the great number of CPs, ascribes the enclosure at Bedhat esh-Sha'ab to the IA I Central Hill County culture, but the site also has its own fingerprints, still not completely clear to us.

4 Based on an unpublished statistical analysis.

5 20% of the indicative excavated IA pottery registered as "miscellaneous".

6 4% of the indicative excavated IA pottery registered as "miscellaneous".

The flint assemblage (H. Winter)

General

A few flint artefacts were found on the surface during the survey of the site. In course of the excavation in 18 loci, more artefacts were unearthed, yielding a total of 70 items (Table B3) which are the subject of this discussion. Neither in the survey nor in the excavation were any flint artefacts indicating a specific historic or prehistoric period found; thus we had to rely on the dating of the ceramic assemblage. Most ceramic sherds were attributed to IA I (and a few to IA II), and apparently the flint assemblage should be affiliated with the IA in general.

Description of the assemblage and discussion

Flint artefacts were found in all areas except Area E; but cores, a hammer-stone, industrial waste and retouched tools were present only in Area B. All these are not natural or sporadic findings, but products of an ordinary flaking process. Most items were flakes which could be used for various tasks without retouch. For the shaping of retouched tools only a minimum of effort was invested. These tools are defined as 'ad hoc' tools (Rosen 1997: 34, 158, 159). Because of the small number of artefacts conclusions should be considered carefully.

There are several possible reasons for the small number of items found: the limited scope of the excavation in two short seasons; and the fact that the items are intrusive, or were brought to the site with filling soil: however, the findings in Area B do not support the second assumption.

The excavation proved that the site was occupied during one single period, mainly the IA, and extensive work was invested in its construction. The modest number of flint artefacts found does not point to a permanent occupation of the site, but it may indicate short periodic returns.

The most reasonable explanation is that the site served as a periodic gathering place for a certain population with an economy based on herding. These groups of semi-nomads wandered in the area of the Jordan Valley according to the season and pasture opportunities. Their lifestyle included gathering – from time to time at a central assembly place (Kaufman 1992). The modest numbers of sherds and flint items support this notion.

Summary and evaluations

The assemblage consists of simple, quite carelessly prepared, 'ad hoc' tools common in this period. Only in Area B is the whole sequence of flint knapping

Area	Locus	Core	Primary Flake	Chunk	Chip	Flake	Blade	Hammer stone	Scraper	Side Scraper	Burin	Notch	Sum
A	11001					3			1				4
A	11003					1	1						2
A	21022					1							1
A1	21020			2	2	3			1				8
A1	21021		2	2			1						5
A1	21025		1	1									2
A1	21026					1					1		2
A1	21027			1									1
A1	21028			1									1
A3	21041			1		1							2
A3	21042					1							1
A3	21046					1							1
B	12001	1		2		4		1		1		1	10
B	12003	1	1										2
B	12005		4	4		2						1	11
C	13004			1		1		1					3
D	14006		1										1
Not recorded			1	3		4							8
Surface						4				1			5
Total		2	10	18	2	27	2	2	2	2	1	2	70

Table B3. The flint finds.

present. The analysis of the assemblage confirms the continued utilization of flint tools for diverse activities in the IA. Flint artefacts are scattered throughout the area, but their small number excludes the possibility of a permanent human presence at the location; but, however, may indicate a periodic gathering for short periods. The absence of flint sickle blades, generally in use in farming communities of the period, indicates that in this case the economy of the communities was based on herding, either because of tradition, or as a result of climatic conditions in this semi-arid area.

Further excavations yielding more and/or indicative artefacts could change this evaluation.

Stone tools

Twelve stone tools were retrieved in the excavation (Fig. B17, Tab. B4): seven from Area A (three were surface finds), and five from Area B1 (one surface find). All were found broken, and no traces of re-use were noted. The commonest material was basalt (six items), followed by sandstone (four), hard limestone (one), and conglomerate (one). All these materials are to be found in the Jordan Valley and its vicinity. Most of the tools (11) were used in the food preparation process, mainly in grinding activities. The use of these tools in the food preparation process, together with the fact that no re-use signs were noted, is important in deciphering the meaning of the site. Also worth noting is the fact that all were found well-used and broken, perhaps reflecting a symbolized discard method. A similar picture emerges from the stone tool assemblage in the cultic site on Mt. Ebal (personal observation). It may be suggested that this pattern of behaviour is not typical of regular habitation sites, and is more appropriate to a seasonal and/or cultic site.

Tool typology:

- *Lower grinding stones* were the commonest type at the site. The seven items were made of basalt (5 items: 4-6, 9-10 in Table B4) and sandstone (2 items: 2 and 12 in Table 4). Their general form is concave, and they can be divided into two sub-types of lower grinding stone: with a shallow working surface (items 4, 6, 10), and with a deeper working surface (5, 9). Parallels for both types have been found in many IA sites on both sides of the River Jordan: Hazor XII-XI (Yadin et al. 1961: pls. CCII:26; CCVI:18), Kinneret IB (Fritz 1990: pl. 111), Beth-Shean (Yadin and Geva 1986: fig. 39), and others.
- *Upper grinding stones* - three convex items were found: basalt (no. 8), sandstone (no. 1), and hard conglomerate (no. 7). Parallels were found in

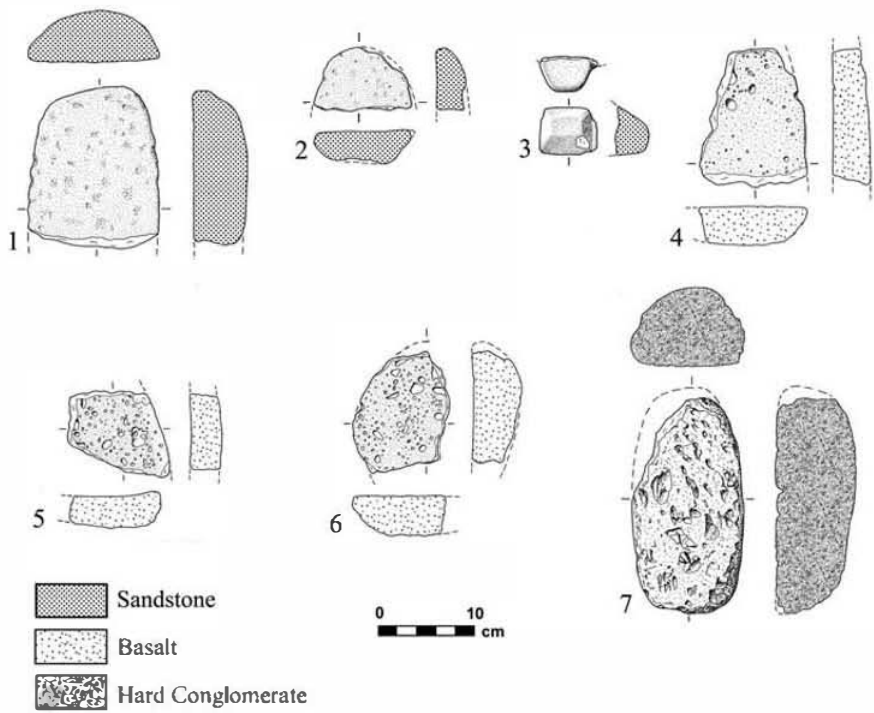


Fig. B17. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – selected items from the stone tool assemblage.

No.	Area	Location	Material	Type	Preservation	Size (L/W/H)
1	B	Surface	Sandstone	Upper grinding loaf-shaped	60%	17/14/6
2	A	Surface	Sandstone	Lower grinding	20%	10/6/3
3	B	L12005	Sandstone	Leg of a bowl?	?	6/5/4
4	A	Surface	Basalt	Lower grinding	40%	14/11/4
5	B	L12005	Porous basalt	Lower grinding	20%	13/9/4
6	A3	L21041	Basalt	Lower grinding	30%	14/9/5.5
7	A3	W21042	Conglomerate	Upper grinding loaf-shaped	95%	24/12/9
8	A	L21001	Porous basalt	Upper grinding loaf-shaped	20%	11/7/4.5
9	A	L11001	Porous basalt	Lower grinding	20%	12/7.5/3
10	A	L12005	Basalt	Lower grinding	10%	10/5/4
11	B	L12005	Limestone	Pestle?	?	3.5/3/1
12	A	Surface	Sandstone	Lower grinding	?	8/7/4

Table B4. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab - the stone tool assemblage.

Hazor XI, IX (Yadin et al. 1961: pl. CCVI: 17, 19-20).

- *Leg of a bowl?* (no. 3) from Area B1: made of sandstone well worked on all its sides.
- *Pestle?* (no. 11) from Area B1: made of hard greyish limestone, well worked and partly smoothed into a cylinder.

A 'Cassid lip' shell

A 'cassid lip' shell was found in Area B2 adjacent to W50041 (L22001) in a greyish erosive soil layer above floor F22006. The length of the rim is 45 mm and the width is 7 mm (Fig. B18). One of its ends is complete and the other is worked.

This item belongs to the *Phalium granulatum* species (Fig. B19), originating in the Mediterranean Sea. This shell is usually found complete in the sandy soils of the shallow or deep waters of the Mediterranean. The wide part of this shell – the 'cassid lip', is common in sites dating from the Neolithic to the Roman periods. It was widespread in the Levant, and some items were also reported from Turkey, Cyprus and Europe (Bar-Yosef Mayer, D. personal communication).

According to Reese (1989: 33-93), there was a link between this item and burial and cultic traditions. They were usually personal burial or cultic goods. He divided the shells into two groups: perforated and unperforated. This item belongs to the second group. Bar-Yosef Mayer (2000: 482) accepted Reese's ideas, and regarded these shells as amulets.

Parallels dating to the LBA and IA have been found in many sites in the region, such as Megiddo (eight were found in an IA tomb - Guy 1938: fig. 166a; 20 others were found in different fills in the excavation - Reese 1989: 35; and three IA items were found in strata K3-4 and H3 in the renewed excavation



Fig. B18. Bedhat esh-Sha'ab – a 'cassid lip' shell from Area B2.

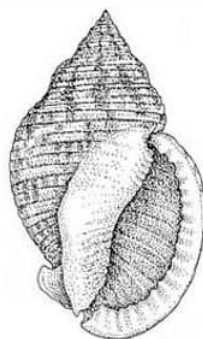


Fig. B19. A *Phalium granulatum* shell.

- Bar-Yosef Mayer 2000: 482-3, fig. 16.3.15), Ta'anach (two items, one of them perforated, were dated to the 12th century BCE - Lapp 1967a: fig. 24; 1967b: fig. 14), and Beth Shean (Reese 1989: 36). Examples from distant areas include Mari (three items shaped as animal heads were discovered in the temple of Ishtar - Parrot 1956: 165, pl. 165), Kaş in Turkey (four items from a shipwreck dated to the 14th century BCE - Reese 1989: 36), Hala Sultan Tekke (Two items dated to the 12th century BCE - Demetropoulos 1979: 138), and Amathus (eight items dated to the 6th century BCE - Reese 1989: 37) in Cyprus.

Faunal remains (G. Bar-Oz and N. Raban-Gerstel)

This report presents the faunal remains from the 2002-2003 excavation seasons at the site. The bones were analyzed at the Laboratory of Archaeozoology at the University of Haifa. The bones studied were from the IA, including bones from three loci that most probably derived from IA contexts (L21042, L21022, and L21001). Skeletal elements were identified to taxon (genus or species level), and were coded according to their anatomic location. Whenever possible the age of the specimen was noted, based on bone fusion or dental wear. In addition, bone surface modifications, such as butchery marks or burning, were coded.

The skeletal elements comprised 148 bone fragments, most of which were highly fragmented and could not be identified to species level with certainty. The distribution of animal bones by area locus and basket, and additional data is given in Table B5.

The assemblage comprised 26 identified bones, of which 22 were sheep/goat, three were cattle, and one was equid. One of the sheep/goat bones (molar tooth) was burnt. The equid bone was most probably from a donkey (*Equus asinus*). Donkeys were among the most abundant transport equids in that period (Wapnish and Hesse 1991).

One of the cattle bones was of a young individual. The presence of cattle may indicate that the site was also inhabited in the winter. This observation is supported by other types of evidence that support the hypothesis that the site was inhabited seasonally.

Summary and Conclusions

The site is a single-period enclosure planned and constructed in the shape of a foot. This pattern is typical of a group of similar sites in the Jordan Valley. It is situated in a narrow valley at the foot of a cliff-like slope which is dotted with many large square boulders resembling giant benches.

The enclosure is enclosed by a well-built wall 2-3 m wide with masonry

	<i>Bos taurus</i>	<i>Capra/Ovis</i>	<i>Equus</i> sp.	Location
Head:				
Mandible		3		A1: L21021
Mandibular condyle		1		A1: L21021
Teeth	2	6		<i>Capra/Ovis</i> : A1: L21021; A3: L21043; A3: L21048; A4: L21001 <i>Bos taurus</i> : A1: L21021; D: L14006
Body:				
Thoracic vertebrae		1		A1: L21021
Rib fragment		2		A1: L21021 A4: L11003
Forelimb:				
Scapula		1		A1: L21021
Radius		1		A3: L21048
Metacarpus		1	1	<i>Capra/Ovis</i> : A1: L21021 <i>Equus</i> sp.: A1: L21021
Hindlimb:				
Tibia		4		A1: L21021
Calcaneum	1 (unfused)			A3: L21043
Unidentified long bone		2		
NISP	3	22	1	=26
%NISP	12.3	85.4	4.3	=100
MNI	1	2	1	=4

Table B5. Faunal remains.

consisting of two rows of large fieldstones. The length of this wall is about 400 m. In Area B this wall (U11) changes to a double wall with a paved surface between the outer walls. This is suggested to be a circular causeway (or 'ceremonial way?') around parts of Area B – the 'heel' of the 'foot'.

The area inside is divided into three levelled parts descending from the south-west to the north-east. Of the five areas researched, only Area A contained an inner construction. The other areas were only levelled and paved. The most prominent feature in the inner parts of the site is the round construction U10 ('bama?').

The site was located near the low flat areas of the Jordan Valley, not in a strategic position, and far from any water source.

Chronology

Judging by the pottery assemblage, the site was built during the IA I, at the end of the 13th century or the beginning of the 12th century BCE. The main activity took place during the 12th-11th centuries BCE, and after the 10th century a gradual decline is indicated by the amount of pottery finds. It seems that in the days of the Kingdom of Israel (IA II) the site continued to function as a cultic centre, but its importance gradually declined, finally being abandoned in the 8th century BCE.

Architecture

The site has architectural features only paralleled in the other foot-shaped enclosures in the Jordan Valley:

1. It was planned and executed according to a ritualistic concept, probably connected to the spiritual mind-set of the builders.
2. The site is a largely paved enclosure surrounded by a temenos wall. Most of the area of the enclosure is empty, except for dividing walls, a circular 'bama' in Area A, and an inner courtyard in Area D. The enclosure wall masonry had some significance, as it is not built for defense or any other obvious use. It is obvious that the site was not intended for habitation.
3. There is a great difference between the power and ideas invested in the construction of the enclosing architecture and the paucity of the inner construction (apart from U10 and courtyard D).
4. No changes in construction were noted in the hundreds of years that the site was active. This probably means that the use and meaning of the site did not change during this long period.
5. The location beneath the slope has significance. It is probable that this slope served as an assembly place for the people who attended the activities in this possibly ritual site. It may be suggested that this was one of the first 'proto-theatres' of the ancient world.
6. 'Way' U11 was used to process around the 'heel' in Area B, probably in ritual-related occasions. The encircling ceremonial procession is known in many sacred sites and texts in the ancient Levant. No other logical explanation for the use of 'way' U11 can be suggested here.
7. The 'bama' U10 in Area A4 was probably the centre of activities at the site. This stems not only from its unique unparalleled architecture, but also from the large quantity of bones and cooking vessels found in its close vicinity. Circular ritual 'bamot' are known from Megiddo and Abu-Zarqun, but this is the first and only 'bama' from the IA in the region.

8. Some parts of the site were paved, especially in Areas A, B and C. This pavement is the main reason for rejecting the possibility that the site was used to gather animal flocks, and raises the possibility that the inner part of the site could have also accommodated an audience.
9. The funnel-shaped entrance to the site was planned to allow people to enter the inner parts of the site as well as the 'way' U11.
10. Area D is one of the best preserved parts of the site, and the large investment in construction is worth noting. The walls survived to a height of almost 2 m, and their use is not known. It is interesting to note that the corners of the courtyard point to the four cardinal directions.

Finds

Pottery— the concentration of cooking vessels around U10 attests to food preparation and consumption activities near the 'bama'. On the other hand, the absence of collared-rim pithoi is striking. The other pottery types and patterns of use are similar to those found in other IA I sites in the region. There is a sharp contrast between the masonry and possible interpretations based on the architecture, and the relatively meagre ceramic finds. This might be explained by possible seasonal activities at the site.

Flint— the very restricted variety of tool types discovered included only 'ad hoc' components on flake, attesting to relatively minor activities that were carried on in the site, especially in Area B.

Faunal remains— these suggest a pastoral or nomadic culture based on herding. Most of the bones were found near U10, and attest to butchery and feasting activities that occurred there. In all other areas there were almost no faunal remains. The presence of donkey bones may attest to semi-nomadic societies. The 'cassid lip' shell further supports the cultic meaning of the site.

Stone tools— these were mainly used in the food preparation process, especially grinding activities. The tools were found broken, with no signs of re-use.

Functional and historical interpretations

The shape, masonry and investment in construction, the pavements, the 'bama' U10, and the 'processional way' U11, all attest to a unique site, different from the typical IA I sites in the region. It seems that the site served as a cultic place and assembly area for nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes leaving or passing in the Jordan Valley. The site served the local communities during the IA, especially during the first 200 years of this period. The activities that took place and the significance of the cultic events that were performed here are still unknown.

The 'processional way' U11 suggests that Area B was circumambulated as part of these cultic events.

Similar sites are echoed in the Bible - the *Gilgalim* (Zertal 2000: 248-251). These were assembly sites for the ancient Israelite tribes for cultic events, and they were active until the end of the IA. A hint to the identification of this site is found in two chapters in the Bible:

- Josh. 22 mentions a cultic centre established in the Jordan Valley by the eastern Jordan tribes (Gad, Reuben and Half of Manasseh). Goitein (1947) and Mazar (1986) suggested the establishment of an early IA cultic centre near the town of Adam in the Jordan Valley (less than 4 km from this site), which existed side by side with the cultic centre in Shiloh.
- Psalms 78:60 echoes the abandonment of the cultic centre in Shiloh and the location of the *Mishkan* (the 'Dwelling Place', often translated as 'Tabernacle') in Adam. Goitein (1947) and Mazar (1986) suggested that the *Mishkan* was moved to a cultic place in the Jordan Valley.

This site may well be the cultic centre referred to here, and the location of the *Mishkan* of the Israelite tribes in the early IA.

The author also suggested identifying the site with the location of the Tabernacle after the abandonment of Shiloh (Psalm 78: 60)⁷ (Ben-Yosef 2005: 767).

Parallels

The only parallels are located in the Jordan Valley and eastern Samaria, and are reported in this volume (Sites 92 and 105 and Appendix C). Another unpublished site with similar characteristics was found two years ago by the survey team north of Wadi Maquq, and will be published in future publications of the Manasseh Hill Country Survey. All these sites share similar features, and are all dated to the IA I-II. It is possible that these are the Biblical *Gilgalim*. No parallels have been found elsewhere in the Levant.

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⁷ And note that the translation of "adam" from Hebrew to English is not necessarily "human" as in most translations, since it can also be the name of a place - "Adam", which was probably situated in Tel Damia, less than 4 km from the site.

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APPENDIX C

EXCAVATIONS AT YAFIT (3), AN IRON AGE FOOT-SHAPED ENCLOSURE IN THE JORDAN VALLEY

Dror Ben-Yosef

This publication is in memory of Yuval Peleg, archaeologist and friend, who assisted in the excavations of Yafit (3).

Introduction

The Yafit (3) site (Israel New Grid 243900/662800, 230 m below sea level) is located in the south-eastern part of the Sartaba ridge, 1 km south-west of the modern village of Yafit. It is situated below two ridges ('Urqan el-Mastarah and



Fig. C1. An aerial view of Yafit (3), looking south-east (R. Be'eri).

Tal'at 'Amreh), in a wide valley intersected by small wadis. The enclosure has a foot-like shape formed by a wide encircling wall. The enclosure measures 69 m by 47 m, and its area is 3 dunams (●.3 ha) (Figs C1, C2).

This site belongs to a unique group of Iron Age foot-shaped enclosures discovered by the Manasseh Hill Country Survey in the Jordan Valley (Sites 65 and 92 and Appendix B in this volume; Zertal 2008: site 16●). These sites share similar structural characteristics, and are unparalleled in the archaeological database of the Levant.

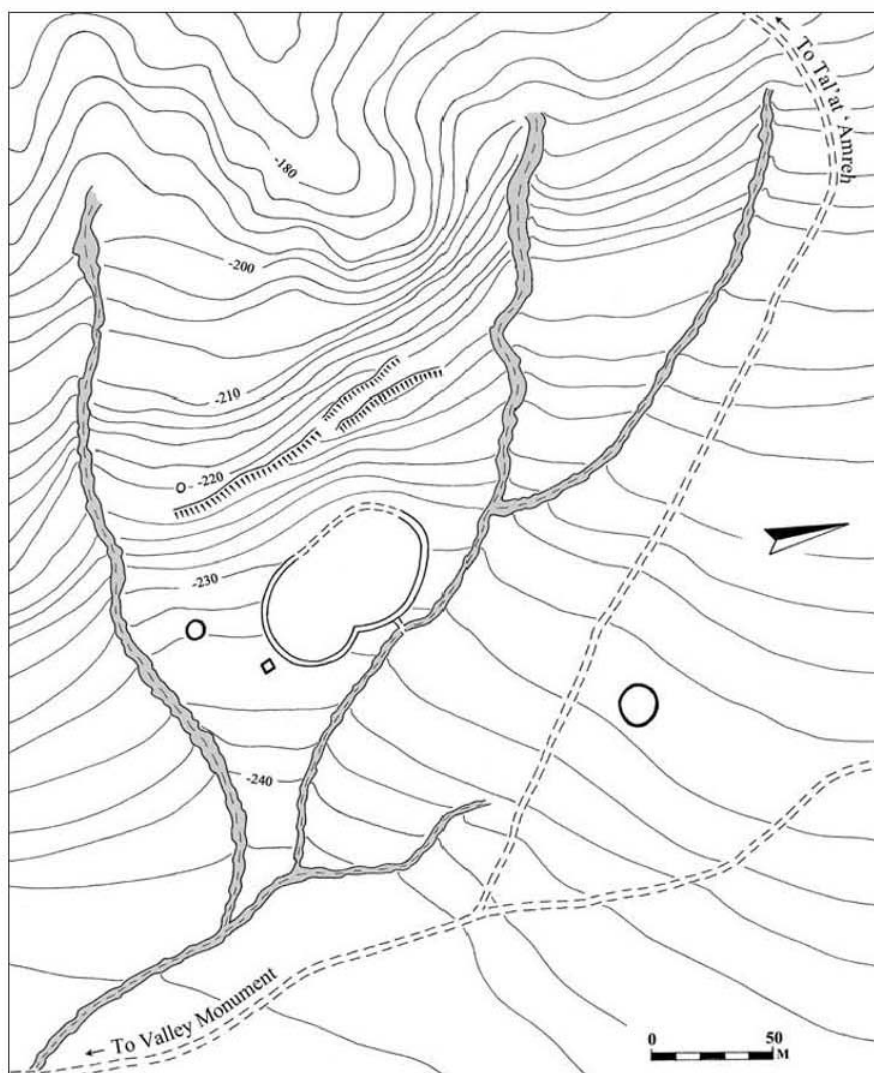


Fig. C2. Yafit (3) – Plan of the site's surroundings (Zertal 2005: fig. 231).

Yafit (3) was discovered in 1996. Its unique architectural features and resemblance to the adjacent excavated foot-shaped enclosure of Bedhat esh-Sha'ab (Ben-Yosef 2007; 2011; Zertal and Ben-Yosef 2009; Appendix B) evoked the need for archaeological excavations at the site.

The Excavations¹

Two strata were found at the site: Stratum 2 is dated to the Iron Age I-II (12th-8th century BCE), when the site was first established (during Iron Age I), and then continued to exist until the 8th century BCE; Stratum 1 is dated to the Late Roman period, when several walls were built inside the enclosure and small-scale activity occurred.

The main architectural feature of the site is a surrounding Stratum 2 wall 2.5 m-wide and 180 m long. This wall comprises three main elements: an external part built of one course of large fieldstones (W11053); an internal part built of two adjacent courses of large fieldstones (W11051- e.g. Squares J4 and J7); and a 1.5 m-wide built path cobbled with small fieldstones (F11057) between these walls. The enclosure wall is best preserved in its southern and eastern parts, while its northern section is only partly visible, and its western part (W24003) is almost completely covered by earth washed down from the slope.

The excavation focused on two main areas (Fig. C3): The enclosure wall (Areas A-C) and a central section through the enclosure oriented east-west (Area D).

Area A

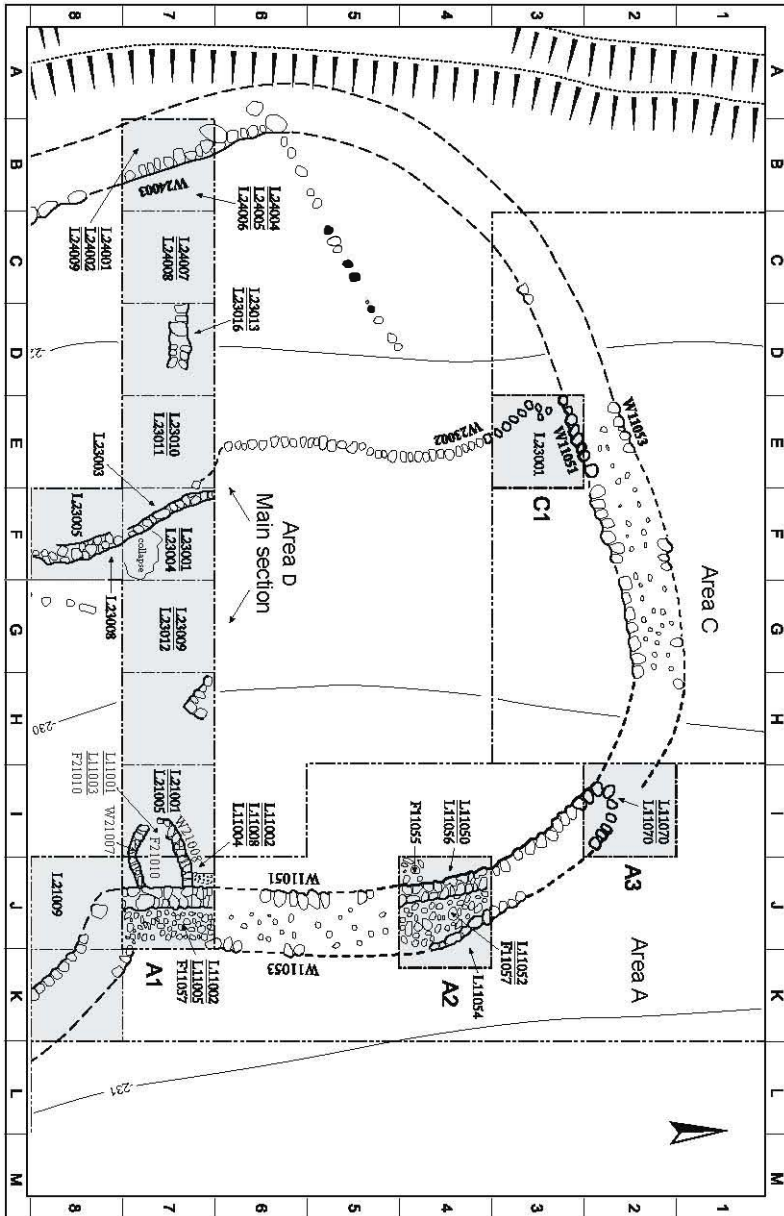
Five squares were excavated in this area, in the north-eastern part of the site, adjacent and inside the site's enclosure wall. The main architectural feature here is the 'knee' of the enclosure wall (J-K/7-8), an element designed to connect the 'sole' of the 'sandal' to its 'heel', thus giving the site its unique plan.

The excavation here revealed the complex masonry of the Stratum 2 enclosure wall, built of the three main elements. In the area of the 'knee' (J-K/7-8)

¹ Two seasons of excavations were conducted at the site in 2005-2006 under the direction of the author and under the auspices of the Zinman Institute of Archaeology of the University of Haifa. Area supervisors were ●. Cohen, D. Ulman, Z. Leiba, M. Tabar, and S. Bar. Financial assistance was given by the Jordan Valley Regional Council, and logistical support was given by the 'Ami Hai' educational programme. I thank all the volunteers who participated in the dig (mainly the University of Haifa, Kinneret College and 'Ami Hai' students) and also A. Zertal (scientific guidance), S. Haad (drawings of plans and finds), A. Shadman (IAA), R. Be'eri (IAA), D. Mantzur (IDF), and Y. Peleg and Y. Zionit (Staff ●fficer of Archaeology in Judea and Samaria).

Bedhat esh-Sha'ab (Ben-Yosef 2007: 228-278; Appendix B).

Two floors abutting the enclosure wall from the west (F11008 and F21010) and an inner wall meeting it (W11006) were found. These were attributed to Stratum 2, and dated to the Iron Age I-II.



Area B

Area B is situated in the southern part of the site, adjacent and inside the site's enclosure wall. A section was excavated in Squares F/14-15 in order to elucidate the masonry of the wall in this section of the site. The enclosure wall is built here in similar masonry to Area A: two walls built with one row of stones, each wall standing two courses high (inner wall W12004 and outer wall W12005). A paved path-like surface between these walls was made of small fieldstones (F12020). Adjacent to wall W12004 on the Stratum 2 living surface to the north were the remains of two oval stone installations (L12010 and L12011) (Fig. C4). The pottery indicates that this wall and pathway were built during the Iron Age I (Stratum 2).

Area C

Area C is situated in the northern part of the site, north-west of Area A, adjacent to the site's enclosure wall (inner wall W11051 and outer wall W11053). A

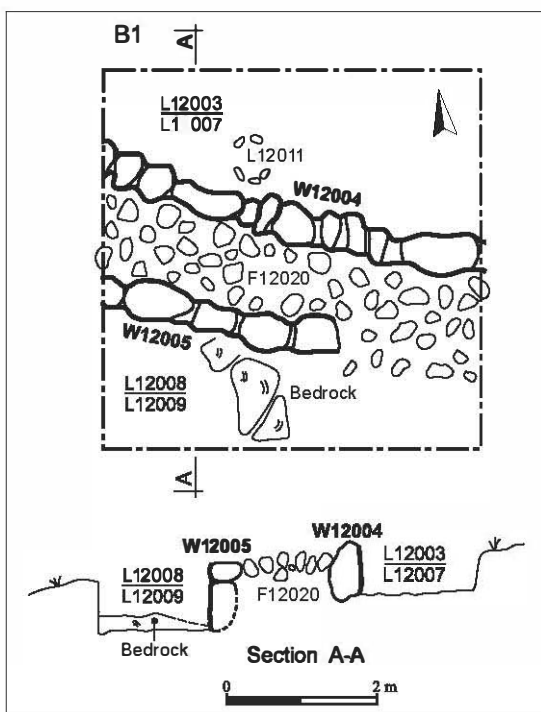


Fig. C4. Yafit (3) Area B – Installations and inner part of the enclosure wall in Square F/15.

15 m section of the Stratum 2 enclosure wall is well preserved here, until it disappears in the west covered by the wash from the slope.

One square was excavated here (E/3) in an area filled with stones, some *in situ*. The small amount of pottery found in these stone piles was dated to the Late Roman period. Another Late Roman feature was a 25 m-long wall (W23002) built of medium-sized stones. This Stratum 1 wall originated in the centre of the site (and was also excavated in Square F/7 in Area D), and reached the northern part of the enclosure (but did not meet the Stratum 2 enclosure wall). The function of these piles of stone remains elusive at this stage of research.

In the northern part of the square the remains of Stratum 2 W11051 were exposed. This wall was the inner part of the enclosure wall, built of one row of large fieldstones. The remains of the other parts of the enclosure wall: the built 'path' and the outer wall (W11053), are visible on the surface to the north of the excavated area.

Area D

This is an area of the site, 47 m long and 4 m wide, running west-east from the slightly higher western enclosure wall (W24003) to the lower 'knee' in Area A1 (Fig. C5). The excavation here revealed both Stratum 1 and Stratum 2 remains. The only significant Stratum 2 remains were found adjacent to the eastern enclosure wall. Near W11051 were found walls W21007, and W21008, and beaten earth floor F21010, all belonging to the same square Iron Age structure abutting the enclosure wall. Thus it seems that most of the area inside the enclosure was an open un-built-up space during the Iron Age.

During the Late Roman period (Stratum 1) the site was resettled and low thin walls were built, but none abutting the enclosure wall. The main feature was the 25 m-long north-south wall W23002 and its continuation to the south. This wall may have supported an animal pen terrace. This assumption is backed by the large amount of Late Roman pottery found in its vicinity and scattered all around the site.

Area E

Area E is situated in the southern part of the site where two walls were excavated: W23020 and W23019. W23020 was visible on the surface prior to the excavation. It is 30 m long and has a wide curve to the south-east. There is a lunar shaped depression almost 1 m deep to the south-east of the wall. The thin wall, W23019, 10 m long and 60 cm wide and one course high, abuts W23020